

ELLIPTIC CURVE COUNTS AND GENERALIZED WEINSTEIN CONJECTURES

ABSTRACT. We use elliptic curve Gromov–Witten theory to probe various generalizations of the Weinstein conjecture. For instance, we prove new cases of Mazzucchelli’s generalization of the Weinstein conjecture, and versions of Sandon’s translated fixed points conjecture. We also state an analogue of the Weinstein conjecture in lcs geometry, directly extending the Weinstein conjecture, and discuss various partial verifications. A counterexample for a stronger form of this conjecture is given. Along the way we give an intriguing formula for certain $\mathbb{Q}$ -valued elliptic Gromov–Witten curve counts in terms of the dynamical Fuller index, which might be of independent interest. The paper aims to be self contained with no knowledge beyond basic Gromov–Witten theory required.

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1. INTRODUCTION

The Weinstein conjecture asserts that the Reeb vector field of any contact form on a closed manifold has a closed orbit [34]. It has been very influential in contact geometry. Attacks on it have produced a range of techniques, most notably the embedded contact homology of Hutchings [14]. In dimension 3 it was proved in full by Taubes [32]. We study some natural generalizations of the Weinstein conjecture. We argue that one natural home for such a generalization is locally conformally symplectic (lcs) geometry. Our methods are based on counts of elliptic curves in lcs manifolds. They are local in nature: they apply to structures sufficiently close to certain model structures. A non-perturbative theory of this kind is at the moment mysterious. We make no attempt at one here.

We will start with the more basic story of fixed Reeb strings of strict contactomorphisms. This will turn out to be closely tied to counts of elliptic curves in certain associated lcs manifolds. From fixed Reeb strings, we are then led to cases of Mazzucchelli's generalization of the Weinstein conjecture, Sandon's translated points, and then to the formulation of the “conformal symplectic Weinstein conjecture”.

Let (C^{2n+1}, λ) be a compact contact manifold with λ a contact form, that is a one form s.t. $\lambda \wedge (d\lambda)^n \neq 0$. Denote by R^λ the Reeb vector field satisfying:

$$d\lambda(R^\lambda, \cdot) = 0, \quad \lambda(R^\lambda) = 1.$$

Recall that a **closed λ -Reeb orbit** (or just Reeb orbit when λ is implicit) is a smooth map

$$o : (S^1 = \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}) \rightarrow C$$

such that

$$\dot{o}(t) = cR^\lambda(o(t)),$$

with $\dot{o}(t)$ denoting the time derivative, for some $c > 0$ called period. Let $S(R^\lambda, \beta)$ denote the space of all closed Reeb orbits in free homotopy class β , with its compact open topology. And set

$$\mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta) := S(R^\lambda, \beta)/S^1,$$

where S^1 is acting naturally by reparametrization $(\theta \cdot o)(t) = o(t + \theta)$.

Definition 1.1. *Let $\phi : (C, \lambda) \rightarrow (C, \lambda)$ be a strict contactomorphism of a contact manifold. Then a fixed Reeb string of ϕ in class β is an element $o \in \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$ fixed by ϕ .*

Theorem 1.2. *For any contact form λ on S^{2k+1} , sufficiently C^1 nearby to λ_{st} (the standard contact form), any strict contactomorphism ϕ of (S^{2k+1}, λ) homotopic to the id via strict contactomorphisms has a fixed Reeb string.*

Let ϕ be a strict contactomorphism of (C, λ) . Following Mazzucchelli [16], a **ϕ -invariant Reeb orbit** is a trajectory γ of R^λ s.t. for some $T \neq 0$, $\phi(\gamma(t)) = \gamma(t + T)$. Hence id-invariant Reeb orbits are precisely closed Reeb orbits. Note also that given a fixed Reeb string of ϕ , represented by γ , the latter is also clearly a ϕ -invariant Reeb orbit.

Conjecture 1.3 (Mazzucchelli [16]). *For any (C, λ) with C closed, every strict contactomorphism ϕ homotopic to the identity via strict contactomorphisms admits a ϕ -invariant Reeb orbit.*

Mazzucchelli [16, Conjecture 1.2] only requires ϕ to preserve λ and to be contact isotopic to the identity, not necessarily through strict contactomorphisms; the above is the special case that we can address. Theorem 1.2, and more generally Theorem 7.9 give:

Corollary 1.4. *Conjecture 1.3, the strict form of Mazzucchelli's generalization of the Weinstein conjecture [16, Conjecture 1.2], holds for C^1 perturbations of (S^{2k+1}, λ_{st}) . Furthermore, it holds for a definite type contact manifold, see Definition 7.8.*

There is a partial connection of the theorem with the theory of translated points.

Definition 1.5 (Sandon [28]). *Given a general contactomorphism ϕ of (C, λ) , a point $p \in C$ is called a **translated point** provided that $\phi^*\lambda(p) = \lambda(p)$ and $\phi(p)$ lies on the λ -Reeb flow line passing through p .*

A fixed Reeb string for ϕ in particular determines a special translated point of ϕ (one for each point on the image of the fixed Reeb string). Hence we get:

Corollary 1.6. *Let ϕ be a strict contactomorphism of (S^{2k+1}, λ) for λ sufficiently C^1 nearby to λ_{st} , then ϕ has a non-empty continuum of translated points.*

Note that the general form of Sandon's conjecture on existence of translated points, [28] has counterexamples on S^{2k+1} for the standard contact form λ_{st} , see Cant [6]. However, it likely holds for any strict contactomorphism of (S^{2k+1}, λ) representing the standard contact structure.

Theorem 1.7. *Suppose that (C, λ) is Morse–Bott and some connected component $N \subset \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$ has non-vanishing orbifold Euler characteristic $\chi^{orb}(N)$, defined in Appendix A. Then for any contact form λ' on C , sufficiently C^1 nearby to λ , any strict contactomorphism ϕ of (C, λ') , homotopic to the id via strict contactomorphisms has a class β fixed Reeb string.*

Both of the theorems above are actually special cases of the following theorem proved in Section 7. For more details on the Fuller index see Appendix A. Let λ be a contact form on a closed manifold C , $N \subset \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$ open and compact, and let $i(N, R^\lambda, \beta) \in \mathbb{Q}$ denote the Fuller index. For example, if λ is Morse–Bott (see [4]) and N is a connected component of $\mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$ then N is naturally a closed orbifold and

$$i(N, R^\lambda, \beta) = \pm \chi^{orb}(N),$$

for $\chi^{orb}(N)$ the orbifold Euler characteristic of N , see (A.4) in Appendix A, cf. [30, Section 2.1.1, proof of Lemma 2.13]. If all the orbits in N have the same multiplicity m then N is a closed manifold and $\chi^{orb}(N) = \chi(N)/m$, for $\chi(N)$ the Euler characteristic.

Theorem 1.8. *Let (C, λ) be a contact manifold satisfying the condition: $i(N, R^\lambda, \beta) \neq 0$, for some open compact $N \subset \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$. Then any strict contactomorphism $\phi : (C, \lambda) \rightarrow (C, \lambda)$, homotopic to the id via strict contactomorphisms has a class β fixed Reeb string $o \in N$.*

We have already mentioned that the index assumption of the theorem holds for Morse–Bott contact forms λ , provided the orbifold Euler characteristic of some component $N \subset \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$ is non-vanishing. We may take for instance the standard contact form λ_{st} on S^{2k+1} , or the unit cotangent bundle of a round sphere, or see Bourgeois [4] for more examples. In this Morse–Bott case, if the underlying topological space of N has $\chi(N) \neq 0$ (which is automatic when all the orbits in N have the same multiplicity), the theorem may be verified by elementary considerations. Indeed, ϕ as above induces a topological endomorphism ϕ_N of N , homotopic to the identity, hence with non-zero Lefschetz number, so that in this case the result follows by the Lefschetz fixed point theorem.

In general a compact open component $N \subset \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$ may not be a finite simplicial complex, or indeed any kind of topological space to which the classical Lefschetz fixed point theorem may apply. Also the relationship of $i(N, R^\lambda, \beta)$ with $\chi(N)$ breaks down in general as $i(N, R^\lambda, \beta)$ is partly sensitive to the dynamics of R^λ .

1.1. Conformal symplectic Weinstein conjecture. The goal is now to describe one analogue of the Weinstein conjecture in locally conformally symplectic geometry, or lcs geometry for short. For preliminaries on this see Section 2.

1.1.1. *Reeb 2-curves.*

Definition 1.9. Let (M, λ, α) be an exact lcs manifold and $\omega = d_\alpha \lambda$. Define X_λ by $\omega(X_\lambda, \cdot) = \lambda$ and X_α by $\omega(X_\alpha, \cdot) = \alpha$. Let $\mathcal{D}$ denote the (generalized) distribution spanned by X_α, X_λ , meaning $\mathcal{D}(p) := \text{span}(X_\alpha(p), X_\lambda(p))$. This will be called the **canonical distribution**.

The canonical distribution $\mathcal{D}$ is one analogue for exact lcs manifolds of the Reeb distribution on contact manifolds. A Reeb 2-curve, as defined ahead, will be a certain kind of singular leaf of $\mathcal{D}$, and so is a kind of 2-dimensional analogue of a Reeb orbit.

Example 1.10. The simplest example of a Reeb 2-curve in an exact lcs manifold (M, λ, α) , in the case $\mathcal{D}$ is a true 2-dimensional distribution (for example if (λ, α) is first kind), is a closed immersed surface $u : \Sigma \rightarrow M$ tangent to $\mathcal{D}$. However, it will be necessary to consider more generalized curves.

Definition 1.11. Let Σ be a closed nodal Riemann surface (the set of nodes can be empty). Let $u : \Sigma \rightarrow M$ be a smooth map and let $\tilde{u} : \tilde{\Sigma} \rightarrow M$ be its normalization (see Definition 7.1). We say that u is a **Reeb 2-curve** in (M, λ, α) , if the following is satisfied:

- (1) For each $z \in \tilde{\Sigma}$, $\tilde{u}_*(T_z \tilde{\Sigma}) = \mathcal{D}(\tilde{u}(z))$, whenever $d\tilde{u}(z) : T_z \tilde{\Sigma} \rightarrow T_{\tilde{u}(z)} M$ is non-zero, and $\dim \mathcal{D}(\tilde{u}(z)) = 2$.
- (2) $0 \neq [u^* \alpha] \in H^1(\Sigma, \mathbb{R})$.

It is tempting to conjecture that every closed exact lcs manifold has a Reeb 2-curve, in analogy to the Weinstein conjecture. However this is false:

Theorem 1.12. Let T^2, g_{st} be the 2-torus with its standard flat metric. Let $M_{\tilde{\phi}, 1}$ be the mapping torus of the unit cotangent bundle of T^2 , with $\tilde{\phi}$ corresponding to an isometry $\phi : (T^2, g_{st}) \rightarrow (T^2, g_{st})$, no power of which fixes the image of any closed geodesic (an irrational rotation in both coordinates). Then $M_{\tilde{\phi}, 1}$ has no Reeb 2-curves.

1.1.2. *Reeb 1-curves.* We can repair the tempting conjecture above by working with a more flexible notion, which is as follows.

Definition 1.13. A smooth map $o : S^1 \rightarrow M$ is a **Reeb 1-curve** in an exact lcs manifold (M, λ, α) , if

$$\forall t \in S^1 : (\lambda(o'(t)) > 0) \wedge (o'(t) \in \mathcal{D}(o(t))).$$

Definition 1.14. We say that an exact lcs manifold (M, λ, α) satisfies the **Reeb condition** if:

$$\lambda(X_\alpha) > 0.$$

The following is elementary and is proved in Section 3.

Proposition 1.15. Every closed exact lcs surface satisfying the Reeb condition has a Reeb 1-curve.

We will refer to the following as the conformal symplectic Weinstein conjecture.

Conjecture 1.16. Suppose that (M, λ, α) is a closed exact lcs manifold of dimension 4 satisfying the Reeb condition, then it has a Reeb 1-curve.

In special cases, the conjecture reduces to the Weinstein conjecture in dimension three. For example:

Theorem 1.17. *Suppose that (M, λ, α) (as in the statement of the conjecture) has a codimension one closed submanifold C , which is transverse to the vector field X_λ of Definition 1.9 and such that $d\lambda$ is degenerate along C , then the conjecture is satisfied for this structure.*

Proof. A simple instructive exercise shows that in this case $(C, \lambda|_C)$ is contact. The condition that $d\lambda$ is degenerate along C , readily implies that $\ker d\lambda = \text{span}(X_\alpha, X_\lambda)$ along C , which in turn ensures that any closed $\lambda|_C$ -Reeb orbit, gives a Reeb 1-curve in M . And so by the proof of Taubes [32] of the Weinstein conjecture in dimension three, the conformal symplectic Weinstein conjecture holds in this case. $\square$

Proposition 1.18. *The analogue of Conjecture 1.16, in all dimensions, implies the Weinstein conjecture: every closed contact manifold (C, λ) has a closed Reeb orbit.*

Proof of Proposition 1.18. Let $(M = C \times S^1, \lambda, \alpha)$ be the lcs-fication of a closed contact manifold (C, λ) , see Example 2.3. Then it satisfies the Reeb condition. Suppose that $o : S^1 \rightarrow M$ is a Reeb 1-curve. Then

$$\forall t \in [0, 1] : \lambda(\dot{o}(t)) > 0$$

and o is tangent to $\mathcal{V}_\lambda = \mathcal{D}$. Consequently, $pr_C \circ o$ is tangent to $\ker d\lambda$, and

$$\forall \tau \in [0, 1] : \lambda((pr_C \circ o)'(\tau)) > 0.$$

It follows that $pr_C \circ o$ is a Reeb orbit of (C, λ) up to parametrization. $\square$

Theorem 1.19 (Weaker form of Corollary 3.5). *Let λ be a nondegenerate contact form on closed 3-manifold C . For exact lcs structures suitably C^∞ nearby to the lcs-fication structure (λ, α) on $C \times S^1$, there is a Reeb 1-curve.*

1.2. Organization. The main theorems are proved in Section 7. Section 2 presents detailed preliminaries for lcs geometry, which should make this paper self contained and accessible to a general reader.

2. PRELIMINARIES ON LCS MANIFOLDS

Definition 2.1. *A locally conformally symplectic manifold or just an lcs manifold, is a smooth $2n$ -fold M with an lcs structure: which is a non-degenerate 2-form ω , with the property that for every $p \in M$ there is an open $U \ni p$ such that $\omega|_U = f_U \cdot \omega_U$, for some symplectic form ω_U defined on U and some smooth positive function f_U on U .*

These kinds of structures were originally considered by Lee in [15], arising naturally as part of an abstract study of “a kind of even dimensional Riemannian geometry”, and then further studied by a number of authors see for instance, [2] and [33]. An lcs manifold admits all the interesting classical notions of a symplectic manifold, like Lagrangian submanifolds and Hamiltonian dynamics, while at the same time forming a much more flexible class. For example Eliashberg and Murphy show that if a closed almost complex $2n$ -fold M has $H^1(M, \mathbb{R}) \neq 0$ then it admits an lcs structure, [8]. Another result of Apostolov–Dloussky [1] is that any complex surface with an odd first Betti number admits an lcs structure, which tames the complex structure.

To see the connection with the first cohomology group $H^1(M, \mathbb{R})$, mentioned above, let us point out right away the most basic invariant of an lcs structure ω , when M has dimension at least 4. This is the Lee class, $\alpha = \alpha_\omega \in H^1(M, \mathbb{R})$. This class has the property that on the associated α -covering space (see proof of Lemma 6.1) $\widetilde{M}$, the lift $\widetilde{\omega}$ is globally conformally symplectic. Thus, an lcs form is globally conformally symplectic, that is equal to $e^f \cdot \omega'$, with ω' symplectic, iff its Lee class vanishes.

Again assuming M has dimension at least 4, the Lee class α has a natural differential form representative, called the Lee form, which is defined as follows. We take a cover of M by open sets U_a in which

$\omega = e^{f_a} \cdot \omega_a$ for ω_a symplectic. Then we have 1-forms $d(f_a)$ on each U_a , which glue to a well-defined closed 1-form on M , as shown by Lee. We may denote this 1-form and its cohomology class both by α . It is moreover immediate that for an lcs form ω ,

$$d\omega = \alpha \wedge \omega,$$

for α the Lee form as defined above.

As we mentioned lcs manifolds can also be understood to generalize contact manifolds. This works as follows. First we have a class of explicit examples of lcs manifolds, obtained by starting with a symplectic cobordism (see [8]) of a closed contact manifold C to itself, arranging for the contact forms at the two ends of the cobordism to be proportional and then gluing the boundary components, (after a global conformal rescaling of the form on the cobordism, to match the boundary conditions).

Terminology 2.2. For us a contact manifold is a pair (C, λ) where C is a manifold and λ a contact form on the $(2n+1)$ -fold C : $\forall p \in C : \lambda \wedge (d\lambda)^n(p) \neq 0$. This is not a completely common terminology as usually it is the equivalence class of (C, λ) that is called a contact manifold, where $(C, \lambda) \sim (C, \lambda')$ if $\lambda = f\lambda'$ for f a positive function. (Given that the contact structure, in the classical sense, is co-oriented.) A **contactomorphism** between $(C_1, \lambda_1), (C_2, \lambda_2)$ is a diffeomorphism $\phi : C_1 \rightarrow C_2$ s.t. $\phi^*\lambda_2 = f\lambda_1$ for some $f > 0$. It is called **strict** if $\phi^*\lambda_2 = \lambda_1$.

A concrete basic example, which can be understood as a special case of the above cobordism construction, is the following.

Example 2.3 (Banyaga). Let (C, λ) be a contact manifold, $S^1 = \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$, $d\theta$ the standard non-degenerate 1-form on S^1 satisfying $\int_{S^1} d\theta = 1$. And take $M = C \times S^1$ with the 2-form

$$\omega_\lambda = d_\alpha \lambda := d\lambda - \alpha \wedge \lambda,$$

for $\alpha := pr_{S^1}^* d\theta$, $pr_{S^1} : C \times S^1 \rightarrow S^1$ the projection, and λ likewise the pull-back of λ by the projection $C \times S^1 \rightarrow C$. We call (M, ω_λ) as above the **lcs-fiction** of (C, λ) . This is also a basic example of a first kind lcs manifold, as in Definition 2.6 ahead.

The operator

$$(2.4) \quad d_\alpha : \Omega^k(M) \rightarrow \Omega^{k+1}(M)$$

$d_\alpha \eta := d\eta - \alpha \wedge \eta$, is called the Lichnerowicz differential with respect to the closed 1-form α , and it satisfies $d_\alpha \circ d_\alpha = 0$ so that we have an associated Lichnerowicz chain complex.

Definition 2.5. An exact lcs form on M is an lcs 2-form s.t. there exists a pair of one forms (λ, α) with α a closed 1-form, s.t. $\omega = d_\alpha \lambda$ is non-degenerate. In the case above we also call the pair (λ, α) an **exact lcs structure**. The triple (M, λ, α) will be called an **exact lcs manifold**, but we may also call (M, ω) an exact lcs manifold when (λ, α) are implicit.

An exact lcs structure determines a generalized distribution $\mathcal{V}_\lambda$ on M :

$$\mathcal{V}_\lambda(p) = \{v \in T_p M \mid d\lambda(v, \cdot) = 0\},$$

which we call the **vanishing distribution**. We also define a generalized distribution ξ_λ that is the ω -orthogonal complement to $\mathcal{V}_\lambda$, which we call **co-vanishing distribution**. For each $p \in M$, $\mathcal{V}_\lambda(p)$ has dimension at most 2 since $d\lambda - \alpha \wedge \lambda$ is non-degenerate. If M^{2n} is closed $\mathcal{V}_\lambda$ cannot identically vanish, since $(d\lambda)^n$ cannot be nowhere vanishing by Stokes theorem.

Definition 2.6. Let (λ, α) be an exact lcs structure on M . We call α **integral**, **rational** or **irrational** if its periods are integral, respectively rational, or respectively irrational. We call the structure (λ, α) **scale integral**, if $c\alpha$ is integral for some $0 \neq c \in \mathbb{R}$. Otherwise we call the structure **scale irrational**. If $\mathcal{V}_\lambda$ is non-zero at each point of M , so that, $d\lambda$ having even rank, it is a smooth 2-distribution,

then such a structure is called **first kind**. If ω is an exact lcs form then we call ω integral, rational, irrational, or first kind if there exists λ, α s.t. $\omega = d_\alpha \lambda$ and (λ, α) is integral, respectively rational, respectively irrational, respectively first kind. Similarly define, scale integral, scale irrational ω .

For any exact lcs structure $\mathcal{V}_\lambda \subset \mathcal{D}$: if $d\lambda(v, \cdot) = 0$ then $\iota_v \omega = \lambda(v)\alpha - \alpha(v)\lambda$, so that $v = \lambda(v)X_\alpha - \alpha(v)X_\lambda$. If the structure is first kind then both $\mathcal{V}_\lambda$ and $\mathcal{D}$ are 2-dimensional, so $\mathcal{V}_\lambda = \mathcal{D}$. Then $X_\alpha \in \ker d\lambda$, while $d\lambda(X_\alpha, \cdot) = (1 - \lambda(X_\alpha))\alpha$, using $\alpha(X_\alpha) = \omega(X_\alpha, X_\alpha) = 0$. Moreover α vanishes nowhere, as $\dim \mathcal{D} = 2$ forces $X_\alpha \neq 0$. Hence $\lambda(X_\alpha) = 1$ everywhere on a first kind exact lcs manifold.

Definition 2.7. A **conformal symplectomorphism** of lcs manifolds $\phi : (M_1, \omega_1) \rightarrow (M_2, \omega_2)$ is a diffeomorphism ϕ s.t. $\phi^* \omega_2 = e^f \omega_1$, for some f . Note that in this case we have an induced relation (when M_1, M_2 have dimension at least 4):

$$\phi^* \alpha_2 = \alpha_1 + df,$$

where α_i is the Lee form of ω_i , $i = 1, 2$. If $f = 0$ we call ϕ a **symplectomorphism**. A (conformal) symplectomorphism of exact lcs structures (λ_1, α_1) , (λ_2, α_2) on M_1 respectively M_2 is a (conformal) symplectomorphism of the corresponding lcs 2-forms. If a diffeomorphism $\phi : M_1 \rightarrow M_2$ satisfies $\phi^* \lambda_2 = \lambda_1$ and $\phi^* \alpha_2 = \alpha_1$ we call it an **isomorphism** of the exact lcs structures. This is analogous to a strict contactomorphism of contact manifolds.

To summarize, with the above notions we have the following basic points whose proof is left to the reader:

- (1) An isomorphism of exact lcs structures (λ_1, α_1) , (λ_2, α_2) preserves the first kind condition, and moreover preserves the corresponding vanishing distributions.
- (2) A symplectomorphism of lcs forms preserves the first kind condition.
- (3) A conformal symplectomorphism of exact lcs structures generally does not preserve the first kind condition.
- (4) A (conformal) symplectomorphism of first kind lcs structures generally does not preserve the vanishing distributions. (Similar to a contactomorphism not preserving Reeb distributions.)
- (5) A conformal symplectomorphism of lcs forms and exact lcs structures preserves the rationality, integrality, scale integrality conditions.

Remark 2.8. In view of the above, in the context of the paper, especially in the context of the conformal symplectic Weinstein conjecture, the correct “gauge group” is the group of symplectomorphisms, rather than conformal symplectomorphisms. Although neither gauge group will be studied in this note.

Remark 2.9. We say that ω_0 is conformally equivalent to ω_1 if $\omega_1 = e^f \omega_0$, i.e. the identity map is a conformal symplectomorphism $\text{id} : (M, \omega_0) \rightarrow (M, \omega_1)$. It is important to note that for us the form ω is the structure not its conformal equivalence class, as for some authors. In other words conformally equivalent structures on a given manifold determine distinct but isomorphic objects of the category, whose objects are lcs manifolds and morphisms conformal symplectomorphisms.

Example 2.10. One example of an lcs structure of the first kind is a mapping torus of a strict contactomorphism, see Banyaga [2]. The mapping torus $M_{\phi, c} := C \times \mathbb{R} / \sim$, $(x, \theta) \sim (\phi(x), \theta + 1)$, of a strict contactomorphism ϕ of (C, λ) fibers over S^1 ,

$$\pi : C \hookrightarrow M_{\phi, c} \rightarrow S^1,$$

and carries the exact lcs structure (λ_ϕ, α) , where λ_ϕ is induced by λ , well defined since $\phi^* \lambda = \lambda$, and where the Lee form is $\alpha = c\pi^*(d\theta)$, for some $0 \neq c \in \mathbb{R}$. In particular, these are scale integral first kind lcs structures.

Moreover we have:

Theorem 2.11 (Only reformulating Bazzoni–Marrero [3]). *A first kind lcs structure (λ, α) on a closed manifold M is isomorphic to the mapping torus of a strict contactomorphism if and only if it is scale integral.*

The (scale) integrality condition is of course necessary since the Lee form of a mapping torus of a strict contactomorphism will have this property. Thus we may understand scale irrational first kind lcs structures as first (and rather dramatic) departures from the world of contact manifolds into a brave new lcs world.

Remark 2.12. Note that scale irrational first kind structures certainly exist. A simple example is given by taking λ, α to be closed scale irrational 1-forms on T^2 with transverse kernels. Then $\omega = \lambda \wedge \alpha$ is a scale irrational first kind structure on T^2 . In particular (λ, α) cannot be a mapping torus of a strict contactomorphism even up to a conformal symplectomorphism. In general, on a closed manifold we may always perturb a (first kind) scale integral lcs structure to a (first kind) scale irrational one. The examples of the present paper deal with deformations of this sort.

3. ON REEB 2-CURVES

Definition 3.1. *Define the set $\mathcal{L}(M)$ of exact lcs structures on M , to be:*

$$\mathcal{L}(M) = \{(\lambda, \alpha) \in \Omega^1(M) \times \Omega^1(M) \mid \alpha \text{ is closed, } d_\alpha \lambda \text{ is non-degenerate}\}.$$

Define $\mathcal{F}(M) \subset \mathcal{L}(M)$ to be the subset of first kind lcs structures.

In what follows we use the following C^∞ metric on $\mathcal{L}(M)$. For $(\lambda_1, \alpha_1), (\lambda_2, \alpha_2) \in \mathcal{L}(M)$ define:

$$(3.2) \quad d_\infty((\lambda_1, \alpha_1), (\lambda_2, \alpha_2)) = d_{C^\infty}(\lambda_1, \lambda_2) + d_{C^\infty}(\alpha_1, \alpha_2),$$

where d_{C^∞} on the right side is the usual C^∞ metric.

The following theorems are proved in Section 7, based on the theory of elliptic pseudo-holomorphic curves in M .

Theorem 3.3. *Let (C, λ) be a closed contact manifold, satisfying one of the following conditions:*

- (1) *(C, λ) has at least one non-degenerate Reeb orbit.*
- (2) *$i(N, R^\lambda, \beta) \neq 0$ where the latter is the Fuller index of some open compact subset of the orbit space: $N \subset \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$, as previously.*

Then we have the following:

- (1) *For some d_∞ neighborhood U of the lcs-fication (λ, α) in the space $\mathcal{F}(M = C \times S^1)$, every element of U admits a Reeb 2-curve.*
- (2) *For any $(\lambda', \alpha') \in U$, the corresponding Reeb 2-curve $u : \Sigma \rightarrow M$ can be assumed to be **elliptic** meaning that Σ is elliptic (more specifically: a nodal, topological genus 1, closed, connected Riemann surface).*
- (3) *If α' is integral, so that charge is defined, then u can also be assumed to be α' -charge 1 (see Definition 4.6).*
- (4) *If M has dimension 4 then u can be assumed to be embedded and normal (the set of nodes is empty). And so in particular, such a u represents a closed, $(\omega = d_\alpha \lambda)$ -symplectic embedded 2-torus in M .*

Theorem 3.4. *Suppose that (M, λ, α) is an exact lcs manifold satisfying the Reeb condition. If (M, λ, α) has an immersed Reeb 2-curve then it also has a Reeb 1-curve. Furthermore, if it has an immersed elliptic Reeb 2-curve, then this Reeb 2-curve is normal.*

We have an immediate corollary of Theorem 3.3 and Theorem 3.4, using that the Reeb condition of Definition 1.14 holds for the lcs-fication, where $\lambda(X_\alpha) = 1$, and is open in $\mathcal{L}(M)$ for M closed.

Corollary 3.5. *Let λ be a contact form on closed 3-manifold C , with at least one non-degenerate Reeb orbit, or more generally satisfying $i(N, R^\lambda, \beta) \neq 0$ for some open compact N as previously. Then there is a d_∞ neighborhood U of the lcs-fication (λ, α) in the space $\mathcal{F}(C \times S^1)$, s.t. for each $(\lambda', \alpha') \in U$ there is a Reeb 1-curve.*

Lemma 3.6. *Let (M, λ, α) be an exact lcs manifold with M closed then $0 \neq [\alpha] \in H^1(M, \mathbb{R})$.*

Proof. Suppose by contradiction that α is exact and let g be its primitive. Then computing we get: $d_\alpha \lambda = \frac{1}{f} d(f\lambda)$ with $f = e^{-g}$. Consequently, $d(f\lambda)$ is non-degenerate on M which contradicts Stokes theorem. $\square$

Proof of Proposition 1.15. Let (M, λ, α) be a closed exact lcs surface satisfying the Reeb condition. By Lemma 3.6 the identity map $M \rightarrow M$ is an immersed Reeb 2-curve. The claim then follows by Theorem 3.4. $\square$

4. J -HOLOMORPHIC CURVES IN CERTAIN LCS MANIFOLDS

Let M, J be an almost complex manifold and Σ, j a Riemann surface. Recall that a map $u : \Sigma \rightarrow M$ is said to be J -holomorphic if $du \circ j = J \circ du$.

Notation 4.1. We will often say J -**curve** in place of J -holomorphic curve.

First kind lcs manifolds give immediate examples of almost complex manifolds where the L^2 energy functional is unbounded on the moduli spaces of fixed homology class J -curves, as well as where null-homologous J -curves can be non-constant. We are going to see this shortly after developing a more general theory.

Definition 4.2. *Let (M, λ, α) be an exact lcs manifold, satisfying the Reeb condition of Definition 1.14, that is $\omega(X_\lambda, X_\alpha) = \lambda(X_\alpha) > 0$, where $\omega = d_\alpha \lambda$. In this case, $\mathcal{D}$ is a 2-dimensional distribution, and we say that an ω -compatible J is (λ, α) -**admissible** or ω -admissible (when λ, α are implicit) if J preserves the canonical distribution $\mathcal{D}$ and its ω -orthogonal complement $\mathcal{D}^\perp$: $J(\mathcal{D}) \subset \mathcal{D}$ and $J(\mathcal{D}^\perp) \subset \mathcal{D}^\perp$. Then $d\lambda$ tames J on $\mathcal{D}^\perp$ automatically, since $\mathcal{D}^\perp = \ker \alpha \cap \ker \lambda$, on which $\omega = d\lambda$. We call (λ, α, J) as above a **tamed exact lcs structure**, and (ω, J) is called a **tamed exact lcs structure** if $\omega = d_\alpha \lambda$, for (λ, α, J) a tamed exact lcs structure. In this case (M, ω, J) , (M, λ, α, J) will be called a **tamed exact lcs manifold**.*

Admissible J exist by classical symplectic geometry, and the space of such J is contractible, see [21].

Example 4.3. If (M, λ, α) is first kind then by the computation following Definition 2.6, $\omega(X_\lambda, X_\alpha) = 1$ everywhere. In particular, we may find a J such that (λ, α, J) is a tamed exact lcs structure, and the space of such J is contractible. We will call (M, λ, α, J) a **tamed first kind** lcs manifold.

Lemma 4.4. *Let (M, λ, α, J) be a tamed first kind lcs manifold. Then given a smooth $u : \Sigma \rightarrow M$, where Σ is a closed (nodal) Riemann surface, u is J -holomorphic only if*

$$\text{image } d\tilde{u}(z) \subset \mathcal{V}_\lambda(\tilde{u}(z))$$

for all $z \in \tilde{\Sigma}$, where $\tilde{u} : \tilde{\Sigma} \rightarrow M$ is the normalization of u (see Definition 7.1). In particular $\tilde{u}^* d\lambda = 0$.

Proof. By the first kind condition (see the computation following Definition 2.6) we have

$$V := \mathcal{V}_\lambda = \mathcal{D}.$$

Let u be J -holomorphic, so that $\tilde{u}$ is J -holomorphic (by definition of a J -holomorphic nodal map). We have

$$\int_{\tilde{\Sigma}} \tilde{u}^* d\lambda = 0$$

by Stokes theorem. Let $\text{proj}(p) : T_p M \rightarrow V^\perp(p)$ be the projection induced by the splitting $TM = V \oplus V^\perp$.

Suppose that for some $z \in \tilde{\Sigma}$, $\text{proj} \circ d\tilde{u}(z) \neq 0$. By the conditions:

- J is tamed by $d\lambda$ on $V^\perp$.
- $d\lambda$ vanishes on V .
- J preserves the splitting $TM = V \oplus V^\perp$.

we have $\int_{\tilde{\Sigma}} \tilde{u}^* d\lambda > 0$, a contradiction. Thus,

$$\forall z \in \tilde{\Sigma} : \text{proj} \circ d\tilde{u}(z) = 0,$$

so

$$\forall z \in \tilde{\Sigma} : \text{image } d\tilde{u}(z) \subset \mathcal{V}_\lambda(\tilde{u}(z)).$$

□

Example 4.5. Let $(C \times S^1, \lambda, \alpha)$ be the lcs-fication of a contact manifold (C, λ) . In this case

$$X_\alpha = (R^\lambda, 0),$$

where R^λ is the Reeb vector field and

$$X_\lambda = (0, -\frac{d}{d\theta}),$$

minus the vector field generating the natural action of S^1 on $C \times S^1$; the sign is forced by

$$\omega(\partial_\theta, \cdot) = -(\alpha \wedge \lambda)(\partial_\theta, \cdot) = -\lambda.$$

If we denote by $\xi \subset T(C \times S^1)$ the distribution $\xi(p) = \ker \lambda(p) \cap \ker \alpha(p)$, the contact distribution of C , then in this case $\xi = V^\perp$ in the notation above. We then take J to be an almost complex structure on ξ , which is S^1 invariant, and compatible with $d\lambda$. The latter means that

$$g_J(\cdot, \cdot) := d\lambda|_\xi(\cdot, J\cdot)$$

is a J invariant Riemannian metric on the distribution ξ .

There is an induced almost complex structure J^λ on $C \times S^1$, which is S^1 -invariant, coincides with J on ξ and which satisfies:

$$J^\lambda(X_\alpha) = -X_\lambda, \quad \text{that is} \quad J^\lambda(R^\lambda, 0) = (0, \frac{d}{d\theta}).$$

Then $(C \times S^1, \lambda, \alpha, J^\lambda)$ is a tamed integral first kind lcs manifold.

4.1. Charged elliptic curves in an lcs manifold. We now study moduli spaces of elliptic curves in an lcs manifold, constrained to have a certain charge.¹ In the present context, one reason for the introduction of “charge” is that it is now possible for non-constant holomorphic curves to be null-homologous, so we need additional control. Here is a simple example: take $S^3 \times S^1$ with $J = J^\lambda$, for λ the standard contact form; then all the Reeb holomorphic tori (as defined further below) are null-homologous.

By an *elliptic curve* we mean a closed connected Riemann surface of genus one, that is a complex torus, and by a *nodal elliptic curve* a connected nodal Riemann surface of genus one, see Definition 7.1: a complex torus with trees of spheres attached, or a cycle of spheres, of length one (a torus with a pinched cycle) or more, with trees of spheres attached. We use no marked points.

The notion of charge can be defined in a general setting. Let M be a manifold endowed with a closed integral 1-form α . Let $u : T^2 \rightarrow M$ be a continuous map satisfying $[u^*\alpha] \neq 0 \in H^1(T^2, \mathbb{Z})$. We then have a classifying map $g : T^2 \rightarrow S^1$ s.t. $g^*d\theta = c \cdot u^*\alpha$ for some c . Take a component of a regular fiber of g , and let $[\gamma] \in H_1(T^2, \mathbb{Z})$ denote the corresponding class, represented by $\gamma : S^1 \rightarrow T^2$. Let $[\rho] \in H_1(T^2, \mathbb{Z})$, likewise represented by $\rho : S^1 \rightarrow T^2$, be the intersection dual class so that:

$$\langle [\gamma], u^*\alpha \rangle = 0, \quad \langle [\rho], u^*\alpha \rangle \neq 0,$$

where $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle$ is the natural pairing of homology and cohomology. These $[\gamma], [\rho]$ generate $H_1(T^2, \mathbb{Z})$, and $[\gamma] \cdot [\rho] = 1$, where $\cdot$ is the intersection pairing with respect to the standard complex orientation on T^2 .

Definition 4.6. For u, γ, ρ as above. We call

$$n = |\langle [\rho], u^*\alpha \rangle| \in \mathbb{N}_{>0},$$

the α -charge of u , or just the charge of u when α is implicit. Suppose furthermore that $\langle [\rho], u^*\alpha \rangle > 0$. Then the class $[u \circ \gamma] \in \pi_1(M)$ will be called the π -class of u , where here and below $\pi_1(M)$ denotes the set of free homotopy classes of loops in M .

It is easy to see that the α -charge and π -class are independent of the choices above. We extend the definitions to curves $u : \Sigma \rightarrow M$, with Σ a nodal elliptic curve, as follows. If Σ has a smooth genus one component Σ_1 , the charge and the π -class of u are those of $u|_{\Sigma_1}$. Otherwise all components of $\tilde{\Sigma}$ are spheres and $H_1(\Sigma, \mathbb{Z}) \simeq \mathbb{Z}$; if $\rho : S^1 \rightarrow \Sigma$ represents a generator, the charge of u is $|\langle [\rho], u^*\alpha \rangle|$, and the π -class of u is the trivial class. The last convention is forced: if smooth curves of charge n and π -class β Gromov converge to such a u , the pinched loop must be a fiber class γ , since the integral of $u^*\alpha$ over it tends to 0, and $\beta = [u \circ \gamma]$ is then the class of a constant loop. Obviously the charge condition is preserved under Gromov convergence of stable maps. But it is not preserved in homology, so that charge is *not* a functional $H_2(M, \mathbb{Z}) \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$.

Definition 4.7. By the above, associated to a continuous map $u : \Sigma \rightarrow M$ with Σ an elliptic curve, and non-zero α -charge, we have a triple $(A, \beta, n) \in H_2(M, \mathbb{Z}) \times \pi_1(M) \times \mathbb{N}_{>0}$, corresponding to the homology class, the π -class, and the α -charge. This triple will be called the **charge class** of u .

Let (M, J) be an almost complex manifold and α a closed integral 1-form on M non vanishing in cohomology, then we call (M, J, α) a **Lee manifold**. For $n \geq 1$ we define

$$\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^n(J, A, \beta)$$

as the set of equivalence classes of pairs (u, Σ) , for Σ a possibly nodal elliptic curve and $u : \Sigma \rightarrow M$ a J -holomorphic map of charge class (A, β, n) , understood as a Kontsevich stable map when Σ has spherical components. The equivalence relation is $(u_1, \Sigma_1) \sim (u_2, \Sigma_2)$ if there is a biholomorphism

¹The name charge is inspired by the notion of charge in Oh–Wang [25], in the context of contact instantons. However, the respective notions are not obviously related.

$\phi : \Sigma_1 \rightarrow \Sigma_2$ s.t. $u_2 \circ \phi = u_1$. Such a ϕ preserves the charge class, so that $\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^n(J, A, \beta)$ is well defined. There are no marked points, so the automorphism group of an element is its stabilizer in the automorphism group of the domain, which is finite: a non-constant J -holomorphic torus is invariant under no one parameter group of translations, as a J -holomorphic map whose differential has rank at most one everywhere is constant. The expected dimension of $\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^n(J, A, \beta)$ is $2c_1(A)$: the Fredholm index of the operator (6.8), which is $2c_1(A) + 2$ and accounts for the variations of the complex structure of the torus, minus the dimension of its group of translations, which is 2. For the classes A_β of Section 6.1 one has $c_1(A_\beta) = 0$, see the proof of Proposition 7.2, so the expected dimension is 0.

By slight abuse we denote such an equivalence class simply by u , so we may write $u \in \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^n(J, A, \beta)$, with Σ implicit.

4.2. Reeb holomorphic tori in $(C \times S^1, J^\lambda)$. In this section we discuss an important example. Let (C, λ) be a contact manifold and let α and J^λ be as in Example 4.5. So that in particular we get a Lee manifold $(C \times S^1, J^\lambda, \alpha)$.

In this case we have one natural type of charge 1 J^λ -holomorphic tori in $M = C \times S^1$. Let o be a period c closed Reeb orbit of R^λ , and let β be its class in $\pi_1(C) \subset \pi_1(M)$. A **Reeb torus** u_o for o is the map

$$\begin{aligned} u_o : (S^1 \times S^1 = T^2) &\rightarrow C \times S^1 \\ u_o(s, t) &= (o(s), t). \end{aligned}$$

A Reeb torus is J^λ -holomorphic for a uniquely determined holomorphic structure j on T^2 defined by:

$$j\left(\frac{\partial}{\partial s}\right) = c \frac{\partial}{\partial t}.$$

5. ELEMENTS OF GROMOV–WITTEN THEORY OF AN ALMOST COMPLEX MANIFOLD

Throughout we suppose that (M, J) is a compact almost complex manifold, where the almost complex structures J are assumed throughout the paper to be C^∞ .

We first recall the moduli spaces, and the energy quantization theorem. Let $\mathcal{M}_{g,n}(J, A)$ denote the moduli space of isomorphism classes of class A , J -holomorphic curves in M , with domain a genus g closed Riemann surface, with n marked labeled points. Here an isomorphism between $u_1 : \Sigma_1 \rightarrow M$ and $u_2 : \Sigma_2 \rightarrow M$ is a biholomorphism of marked Riemann surfaces $\phi : \Sigma_1 \rightarrow \Sigma_2$ s.t. $u_2 \circ \phi = u_1$.

Theorem 5.1 ([22, Proposition 4.1.4]). *Let (M, J) be a compact almost complex manifold, and $u : (S^2, j) \rightarrow M$ a J -holomorphic map. Given a Riemannian metric g on M , there is an $\hbar = \hbar(g, J) > 0$ s.t. if $e_g(u) < \hbar$ then u is constant, where e_g is the L^2 -energy functional,*

$$e_g(u) = \int_{S^2} |du|^2 \, \text{dvol}.$$

Next we state the basic precompactness theorem.

Theorem 5.2. *Let (M, J) be a compact almost complex manifold. Then $\mathcal{M}_{g,n}(J, A)$ has a precompactification*

$$\overline{\mathcal{M}}_{g,n}(J, A),$$

by Kontsevich stable maps, with respect to the natural Gromov topology see for instance [22, Chapter 5.6], for the genus 0 case, and [26] for the general case. Moreover, given $E > 0$, the subspace $\overline{\mathcal{M}}_{g,n}(J, A)_E \subset \overline{\mathcal{M}}_{g,n}(J, A)$ consisting of elements u with $e(u) \leq E$ is compact, where e is the L^2 energy with respect to an auxiliary J -invariant metric. In other words e is a proper function. More generally, if $J_k \rightarrow J$ in C^2 and u^k are J_k -holomorphic stable maps in class A with $e(u^k) \leq E$, then a subsequence Gromov converges to a J -holomorphic stable map. For closed curves of any genus in a

compact almost complex manifold, with the complex structures of the domains allowed to degenerate, this is proved in Hummel [13].

Proof of Theorem 5.2. (Outline, as the argument is standard.) Suppose that we have a sequence u^k of J -holomorphic maps with L^2 -energy $\leq E$. By [22, Theorem 4.1.1], a sequence u^k of J -holomorphic curves has a convergent subsequence if $\sup_k \|du^k\|_{L^\infty} < \infty$. On the other hand, when this condition does not hold, a rescaling argument tells us that a holomorphic sphere bubbles off. The quantization Theorem 5.1, tells us that the energy of a non-constant J -holomorphic map of $\mathbb{CP}^1$ is at least $\hbar > 0$. So if the energy of the maps u^k is bounded from above by E , only finitely many bubbles may appear, so that a subsequence of u^k must converge in the Gromov topology to a Kontsevich stable map. When the complex structures of the domains degenerate, the same bubbling analysis applies on the long necks, whose thin parts carry little energy and become the nodes of the limit; the details, for any genus and for varying J_k , are in [13]. $\square$

We now specialize to genus 1 and no marked points, the only case used in this paper. Let (M, J, α) be a Lee manifold, and let $\mathcal{M} := \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(J, A, \beta)$ be the moduli space of Section 4.1. It is an open and closed subset of $\overline{\mathcal{M}}_{1,0}(J, A)$, the charge class being locally constant in the Gromov topology, so Theorem 5.2 applies to it; and it contains no constant maps, as $k \geq 1$. Let $N \subset \mathcal{M}$ be an open compact subset, not necessarily connected. In our applications such N appear from concrete geometry, for example they may correspond to components of the space of Reeb strings. Compactness is thus assumed, and is not emergent, and there is no general theory even within lcs geometry where it emerges.

We shall primarily refer in what follows to work of Pardon in [26], being more familiar to the author. However, the original setup of Fukaya–Ono [11], and later expanded with Oh–Ohta [10] can also work here in the same fashion.

5.1. Implicit atlases. The construction in [26] of an implicit atlas on a moduli space of J -curves, here $\mathcal{M}$, ostensibly asks for J to be tamed by a symplectic form. But this is only used to establish compactness. More specifically, let $N \subset \mathcal{M}$ be open and compact, as above. Then the construction in [26] works word for word to establish existence of a natural implicit atlas on N . The openness condition is needed since the thickened moduli spaces of the construction must be neighborhoods of their zero sets, and these zero sets must lie over N (likewise for Kuranishi structures [10].) We sketch the construction, following [26, Section 9.2], to locate the use of the taming form. Let Σ denote the domain of a curve u , a possibly nodal elliptic curve. Pardon’s implicit atlas is indexed by the set A of thickening datums, [26, Definition 9.2.1]. A datum $a \in A$ is a tuple $(Z_a, r_a, \Gamma_a, \overline{M}_a, E_a, \Theta_a)$, (we rename Pardon’s $D_\alpha, \lambda_\alpha, \phi_\alpha, e_\alpha$ to avoid clashes with our notation), consisting of: a compact codimension two submanifold with boundary $Z_a \subset M$; an integer $r_a \geq 1$; a finite group Γ_a ; a smooth Γ_a -manifold $\overline{M}_a$ with $\overline{M}_a/\Gamma_a$ an open subset of $\overline{M}_{1,r_a}/S_{r_a}$, for S_{r_a} the symmetric group, with the pulled back universal curve $\overline{\mathcal{C}}_a \rightarrow \overline{M}_a$; a finite dimensional Γ_a -representation E_a ; and a Γ_a -equivariant linear map $\Theta_a : E_a \rightarrow C^\infty(\overline{\mathcal{C}}_a \times M, \Omega_{\overline{\mathcal{C}}_a/\overline{M}_a}^{0,1} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} TM)$, supported away from the nodes and marked points of the fibers of $\overline{\mathcal{C}}_a$. For a finite $I \subset A$ the thickened moduli space $\mathcal{M}_I$ is the set of isomorphism classes of tuples $(u, \{\psi_a\}_{a \in I}, \{\varepsilon_a\}_{a \in I})$, where $u : \Sigma \rightarrow M$ is a smooth stable map of charge class (A, β, k) , transverse to each Z_a , $a \in I$, with exactly r_a intersection points, $\psi_a : \Sigma \rightarrow \overline{\mathcal{C}}_a$ is an isomorphism of Σ , with the points $u^{-1}(Z_a)$ added as marked points, onto a fiber of $\overline{\mathcal{C}}_a \rightarrow \overline{M}_a$, $\varepsilon_a \in E_a$, and

$$(5.3) \quad \overline{\partial}u + \sum_{a \in I} \Theta_a(\varepsilon_a)(\psi_a, u) = 0,$$

where $\Theta_a(\varepsilon_a)(\psi_a, u)$, the pullback of $\Theta_a(\varepsilon_a)$ by $(\psi_a, u) : \Sigma \rightarrow \overline{\mathcal{C}}_a \times M$, is a $(0, 1)$ -form on Σ with values in u^*TM . $\mathcal{M}_I$ has the Gromov topology, the group $\Gamma_I = \prod_{a \in I} \Gamma_a$ acts on it through the ψ_a and the ε_a , and $E_I = \bigoplus_{a \in I} E_a$. The Kuranishi map is $s_I(u, \psi, \varepsilon) = \varepsilon$. Its zero set consists of the tuples with $u \in \mathcal{M}$, and $s_I^{-1}(0)/\Gamma_I$ is the open subset of $\mathcal{M}$ of curves transverse to the Z_a , $a \in I$, with r_a intersection points, whose domains with these points added are isomorphic to fibers of the $\overline{\mathcal{C}}_a$: the

footprint of I . The regular locus $\mathcal{M}_I^{reg} \subset \mathcal{M}_I$ consists of the tuples with trivial automorphism group at which the linearization of (5.3) in (u, ε) , for the fixed domain Σ , is onto. This is Pardon's atlas on $\mathcal{M}$, when $\mathcal{M}$ is compact. For our N we set

$$N_I := \{(u, \psi, \varepsilon) \in \mathcal{M}_I : \varepsilon \neq 0 \text{ or } u \in N\},$$

discarding the honest solutions outside N , and $N_I^{reg} := N_I \cap \mathcal{M}_I^{reg}$. This is where the openness of N in $\mathcal{M}$ is used: $Z_N := \{\varepsilon = 0, u \in N\}$ is open in the closed set $s_I^{-1}(0)$, as the forgetful map $s_I^{-1}(0) \rightarrow \mathcal{M}$ is continuous, so $s_I^{-1}(0) \setminus Z_N$ is closed in $\mathcal{M}_I$, and N_I is open in $\mathcal{M}_I$, with $s_I^{-1}(0) \cap N_I = Z_N$ and $N_\emptyset = N$. For a compact N not open in $\mathcal{M}$, honest curves outside N would accumulate at points of Z_N , which would then have no neighborhood in N_I that is a manifold, and the submersion axiom below would fail. The virtual fundamental class is extracted from the system $\{(N_I, E_I, s_I, N_I^{reg})\}_I$ by homological algebra, [26, Sections 4, 5].

Pardon's verification of the axioms of an implicit atlas, [26, Definition 3.1.1], for the system $\{\mathcal{M}_I\}_I$ uses no taming form. The compatibility axioms, concerning the forgetful maps $s_{J \setminus I}^{-1}(0) \rightarrow \mathcal{M}_I$, $I \subset J$, are checked from the definitions. The openness and submersion axioms, that $\mathcal{M}_I^{reg}$ is open in $\mathcal{M}_I$ and a topological manifold of dimension $2c_1(A) + \dim E_I$, with $s_{J \setminus I} : \mathcal{M}_J \rightarrow E_{J \setminus I}$ a topological submersion over the preimage of $\mathcal{M}_I^{reg}$ under the forgetful map, are local: they are proved by the implicit function theorem near points with smooth domain, and by gluing near points with nodal domain, [26, Proposition 9.2.6 and Appendix B]. The covering axiom, that every element of $\mathcal{M}$ lies in the footprint of $\mathcal{M}_I^{reg}$ for some I , follows from domain stabilization, [26, Lemma 9.2.8], and from choosing E_a to surject onto the cokernel of the linearized $\bar{\partial}_J$ operator at the given curve. Hausdorffness of the thickenings, also required, holds for any J : for $I \neq \emptyset$ the topology of $\mathcal{M}_I$ is the Hausdorff distance topology on the images of the (ψ_a, u) , and for $I = \emptyset$ it is the Gromov topology of $\mathcal{M}$, Hausdorff in any genus for any almost complex structure, Siebert [31, Propositions 3.8, 3.11, Remark 3.12]. All these conditions are conditions on open subsets and on local models, so they restrict from $\{\mathcal{M}_I\}_I$ to the system $\{N_I\}_I$ of open subsets; for the homeomorphism axiom note that an element of $s_{J \setminus I}^{-1}(0)$ and its image in $\mathcal{M}_I$ have the same u and the same ε , so both lie in the N -system or neither does. In the construction of the atlas the taming form is used in one place: [26, Definition 3.1.1] asks that the moduli space carrying the atlas be compact, which for $\mathcal{M}$ is Gromov compactness. In our situation the moduli space carrying the atlas is N , and its compactness is a hypothesis. So for an *open* compact component N as above, we have a well defined natural implicit atlas, (or a Kuranishi structure in the setup of [11]). And so such an N will have a virtual fundamental class in the sense of [26]. This understanding will be used in other parts of the paper, following Pardon for the explicit setup.

5.2. The Gromov–Witten invariant and its dependence. We may thus define, when $c_1(A) = 0$, so that the virtual dimension $2c_1(A)$ of N vanishes,

$$(5.4) \quad GW_1^k(N, J, A, \beta) := \int_{[N]^{vir}} 1 \in \mathbb{Q},$$

the degree of the virtual fundamental class of N . If N is not specified it is understood to be the whole moduli space (if it is known to be compact).

We now study how these counts depend on N, J . Given a Fréchet smooth family $\{J_t\}$, $t \in [0, 1]$, on M , we denote by $\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(\{J_t\}, A, \beta)$ the space of pairs (u, t) , $u \in \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(J_t, A, \beta)$.

Lemma 5.5. *Let $\{J_t\}$, $t \in [0, 1]$ be a Fréchet smooth family of almost complex structures on M . Suppose that $\tilde{N}$ is an open compact subset of the cobordism moduli space $\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(\{J_t\}, A, \beta)$, with $k > 0$. Let*

$$N_i = \tilde{N} \cap \left(\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(J_i, A, \beta) \times \{i\} \right),$$

then

$$GW_1^k(N_0, J_0, A, \beta) = GW_1^k(N_1, J_1, A, \beta).$$

In particular if $GW_1^k(N_0, J_0, A, \beta) \neq 0$, there is a J_1 -holomorphic, stable, charge class (A, β, k) elliptic curve in M .

Proof of Lemma 5.5. This is the Pardon construction outlined in Section 5.1, applied to cobordisms and the same construction holds. Namely, we may construct exactly as in [26] for the proof that the Gromov–Witten invariants do not depend on J , a natural implicit atlas on $\tilde{N}$, with boundary $N_0^{op} \sqcup N_1$, (op denoting opposite orientation). And so we immediately get

$$GW_1^k(N_0, J_0, A, \beta) = GW_1^k(N_1, J_1, A, \beta).$$

□

Remark 5.6. The condition that $k > 0$ is a simple way to rule out degenerations to constant curves, but is not really essential. In the case the manifold is closed, degenerations of J -holomorphic curves to constant curves are impossible. This can be deduced from energy quantization for non-constant J -holomorphic curves of any genus, which follows from the general monotonicity theorem as appearing in Zinger [39, Proposition 3.12]. This was noted to me by Spencer Cattalani. Even if the manifold is not compact, given the assumption that $\tilde{N}$ itself is compact, we may similarly preclude such degenerations.

We now state a basic technical lemma, following some standard definitions.

Definition 5.7. An **almost symplectic pair** on M is a tuple (ω, J) , where ω is a non-degenerate 2-form on M , and J is ω -compatible, meaning that $\omega(\cdot, J\cdot)$ defines a J -invariant Riemannian metric, denoted by g_J (with ω implicit).

Definition 5.8. We say that a pair of almost symplectic pairs (ω_i, J_i) , $i = 0, 1$, are **δ -close**, if ω_0, ω_1 are C^∞ δ -close, and J_0, J_1 are C^∞ δ -close.

Let $\mathcal{S}^k(A, \beta)$ denote the space of equivalence classes of all smooth, stable maps of nodal elliptic curves into M of charge class (A, β, k) , with the Gromov topology determined by g_J , defined by the same quasi distance functions as for J -holomorphic stable maps, cf. the proof of Lemma 5.9. That is elements of $\mathcal{S}^k(A, \beta)$ are like elements of $\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(J, A, \beta)$ but are not required to be J -holomorphic. In particular, we have a continuous function:

$$e = e_{g_J} : \mathcal{S}^k(A, \beta) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}.$$

Lemma 5.9. Let (ω, J) be an almost symplectic pair on a compact manifold M and let $N \subset \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(J, A, \beta)$ be compact and open (as a subset of $\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(J, A, \beta)$). Then there exists an open $U \subset \mathcal{S}^k(A, \beta)$ satisfying:

- (1) e is bounded on $\overline{U}$.
- (2) $U \supset N$.
- (3) $\overline{U} \cap \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(J, A, \beta) = N$.

Proof. The Gromov topology on $\mathcal{S}^k(A, \beta)$ has a basis $\mathcal{B}$ satisfying:

- (1) If $V \in \mathcal{B}$ then e is bounded on $\overline{V}$.
- (2) If U is open and $u \in U$, then

$$\exists V \in \mathcal{B} : (u \in V) \wedge (\overline{V} \subset U).$$

In the genus 0 case this is contained in the classical text McDuff–Salamon [22, page 140]. The basis $\mathcal{B}$ is defined using a collection of “quasi distance functions” $\{\rho_\epsilon\}_\epsilon$ on the set of stable maps. The higher genus case is likewise well known.

Thus, since N is relatively open, using the properties of $\mathcal{B}$ above, we may find a collection $\{V_a\} \subset \mathcal{B}$ s.t.

- $\{V_a\}$ covers N .
- $\overline{V}_a \cap \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(J, A, \beta) \subset N$.

As N is compact, we have a finite subcover $\{V_{a_1}, \dots, V_{a_n}\}$. Set $U := \cup_{i \in \{1, \dots, n\}} V_{a_i}$. Then U satisfies the conclusion of the lemma. $\square$

Lemma 5.10. *Let (M, ω, J, α) be as above, $N \subset \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(J, A, \beta)$ an open compact set, and U as in the lemma above. Then there is a $\delta > 0$ s.t. whenever J' is C^2 δ -close to J if $u \in \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(J', A, \beta)$ and $u \in \overline{U}$ then $u \in U$.*

Proof. Suppose otherwise, then there is a sequence $\{J_k\}$ C^2 converging to J , and a sequence $\{u_k\} \in \overline{U} - U$ of J_k -holomorphic stable maps. Then by property 1 e_{g_J} is bounded on $\{u_k\}$. Hence, by Gromov compactness for the sequence $J_k \rightarrow J$, Theorem 5.2, we may find a Gromov convergent subsequence $\{u_{k_j}\}$ to a J -holomorphic stable map $u \in \overline{U} - U$. But by Properties 3, 2 of the set U ,

$$(\overline{U} - U) \cap \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(J, A, \beta) = \emptyset.$$

So that we obtain a contradiction. $\square$

Lemma 5.11. *Let M, ω, J, α and $N \subset \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(J, A, \beta)$ be as in the previous lemma. Then there is a $\delta > 0$ s.t. the following is satisfied. Let (ω', J') be δ -close to (ω, J) , then there is a smooth family $\{J_t\}$, $J_0 = J$, $J_1 = J'$ s.t. there is an open compact subset*

$$\tilde{N} \subset \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(\{J_t\}, A, \beta),$$

satisfying

$$\tilde{N} \cap \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(J, A, \beta) \times \{0\} = N \times \{0\}.$$

Proof. First let δ be as in Lemma 5.10. We then need:

Lemma 5.12. *Given a $\delta > 0$ there is a $\delta' > 0$ s.t. if (ω', J') is δ' -near (ω, J) then there is a smooth family $\{(\omega_t, J_t)\}$, $t \in [0, 1]$, satisfying:*

- (ω_t, J_t) is δ -close to (ω, J) for each t .
- $(\omega_0, J_0) = (\omega, J)$ and $(\omega_1, J_1) = (\omega', J')$.

Proof. Let $\{g_t\}$ be the family of metrics on M given by the convex linear combination of $g = g_{\omega, J}$, $g' = g_{\omega', J'}$, $g_t = (1 - t)g + tg'$. Clearly g_t is C^∞ δ' -close to g_0 for each t . Likewise, the family of 2 forms $\{\omega_t\}$ given by the convex linear combination of ω , ω' is non-degenerate for each t if δ' was chosen to be sufficiently small. And each ω_t is C^∞ δ' -close to $\omega_0 = \omega_{g, J}$.

Let

$$ret : Met(M) \times \Omega(M) \rightarrow \mathcal{J}(M)$$

be the “retraction map” (it can be understood as a retraction followed by projection) as defined in [21, Prop 2.50], where $Met(M)$ is the space of metrics on M , $\Omega(M)$ the space of 2-forms on M , and $\mathcal{J}(M)$ the space of almost complex structures. This map has the property that the almost complex structure $ret(g, \omega)$ is compatible with ω , and that $ret(g_J, \omega) = J$ for $g_J = \omega(\cdot, J\cdot)$. Then $\{(\omega_t, ret(g_t, \omega_t))\}$ is

a compatible family. As ret is smooth, the family is smooth in t , and δ' can be chosen such that $\{ret(g_t, \omega_t)\}$ are C^∞ δ -nearby. $\square$

Returning to the proof of the main lemma. Let $\delta' < \delta$ be chosen as in Lemma 5.12 and let $\{(\omega_t, J_t)\}$ be the corresponding family. Set

$$\tilde{N} = \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(\{J_t\}, A, \beta) \cap (U \times [0, 1]),$$

where U is as in Lemma 5.10.

Then $\tilde{N}$ is an open subset of $\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(\{J_t\}, A, \beta)$. By Lemma 5.10,

$$\tilde{N} = \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(\{J_t\}, A, \beta) \cap (\overline{U} \times [0, 1]),$$

so that $\tilde{N}$ is also closed.

Finally, $\sup_{(u,t) \in \tilde{N}} e_{g_t}(u) < \infty$, by condition 1 of U , since the metrics g_t , $t \in [0, 1]$, are uniformly comparable on the compact manifold M . Consequently $\tilde{N}$ is compact by Gromov compactness for sequences $J_{t_k} \rightarrow J_t$, Theorem 5.2. Resetting $\delta := \delta'$, we are then done with the proof of the main lemma. $\square$

Proposition 5.13. *Let (ω, J) be an almost symplectic pair on a compact manifold M , and suppose that $N \subset \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(J, A, \beta)$ is open and compact, with $GW_1^k(N, J, A, \beta) \neq 0$. Then there is a $\delta > 0$ s.t. whenever (ω', J') is an almost symplectic pair δ -close to (ω, J) , there exists $u \in \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(J', A, \beta)$. In particular this holds whenever J' is C^∞ δ' -close to J , for a suitable $\delta' > 0$: the form $\omega'(v, w) := \frac{1}{2}(\omega(v, w) + \omega(J'v, J'w))$ is J' -invariant, satisfies $\omega'(v, J'v) = \omega(v, J'v) > 0$ for J' close to J , and is C^∞ -close to ω .*

Proof. For N as in the hypothesis, let U , δ and $\tilde{N}$ be as in Lemma 5.11, then by the conclusion of that lemma and by Lemma 5.5

$$GW_1^k(N_1, J', A, \beta) = GW_1^k(N, J, A, \beta) \neq 0,$$

where $N_1 = \tilde{N} \cap \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^k(J_1, A, \beta) \times \{1\}$. $\square$

6. ELLIPTIC CURVES IN THE LCS-FICATION OF A CONTACT MANIFOLD AND THE FULLER INDEX

The following elementary result is crucial for us.

Lemma 6.1. *Let (M, λ, α, J) be a tamed first kind lcs manifold. Then every non-constant (nodal) J -holomorphic curve $u : \Sigma \rightarrow M$ is a Reeb 2-curve.*

Proof of Lemma 6.1. Let $u : \Sigma \rightarrow M$ be a non-constant, nodal (possibly empty set of nodes) J -curve. By Lemma 4.4 it is enough to show that $[u^*\alpha] \neq 0$. Let $\widetilde{M}$ denote the α -covering space of M , that is the space of equivalence classes of paths p starting at $x_0 \in M$, with a pair p_1, p_2 equivalent if $p_1(1) = p_2(1)$ and

$$\int_{[0,1]} p_1^* \alpha = \int_{[0,1]} p_2^* \alpha.$$

Then the lift of ω to $\widetilde{M}$ is

$$\tilde{\omega} = \frac{1}{f} d(f\lambda),$$

where $f = e^{-g}$ and where g is a primitive for the lift $\tilde{\alpha}$ of α to $\widetilde{M}$, that is $\tilde{\alpha} = dg$. In particular $\tilde{\omega}$ is conformally symplectomorphic to an exact symplectic form on $\widetilde{M}$. So if $\tilde{J}$ denotes the lift of J , any closed $\tilde{J}$ -curve is constant by Stokes theorem. Now if $[u^*\alpha] = 0$ then u has a lift to a $\tilde{J}$ -holomorphic

map $v : \Sigma \rightarrow \widetilde{M}$. Since Σ is closed, it follows by the above that v is constant, so that u is constant, which is impossible. $\square$

6.1. Preliminaries on Reeb tori. Let $(M = C \times S^1, \lambda, \alpha)$ be the lcs-fication of (C, λ) . For $\beta \in \pi_1(C)$ we set $A_\beta^1 = \beta \otimes [S^1] \in H_2(M, \mathbb{Z})$, which we abbreviate as A_β . Let $\mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$, be the orbit space as in the Introduction. Let J^λ on $C \times S^1$ be as in Section 4.2. We have a map:

$$(6.2) \quad \mathcal{P} : \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta) \rightarrow \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^1(J^\lambda, A_\beta^1, \beta), \quad \mathcal{P}(o) = u_o,$$

for u_o the Reeb torus as previously.

We set up some terminology. Let $pr_C : C \times S^1 \rightarrow C$ and $pr_{S^1} : C \times S^1 \rightarrow S^1$ be the projections. For $o \in \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$ let $m = m(o)$ be its multiplicity, Appendix A, so that $o = o_s^m$ for a simple orbit o_s , and set

$$\mathcal{T}_o := \text{image } u_o = \text{image } o_s \times S^1,$$

an embedded torus, tangent to the distribution $\mathcal{D} = \text{span}(R^\lambda, \partial_\theta)$. For $0 \leq k < m$ define the **sheared Reeb tori**

$$(6.3) \quad u_{o,k} : T^2 \rightarrow M, \quad u_{o,k}(s, t) = (o_s(ms + kt), t),$$

covering maps of degree m onto $\mathcal{T}_o$, of charge 1 and class A_β^1 , with $u_{o,0} = u_o$. Let $u : \Sigma \rightarrow C \times S^1$ be a map from a closed oriented surface and t_0 a regular value of $pr_{S^1} \circ u$; then each component S_0 of $(pr_{S^1} \circ u)^{-1}(t_0)$ is an embedded circle in Σ , oriented as a fiber. We say that u **traces** o on S_0 if $pr_C \circ u|_{S_0}$ is, up to orientation preserving reparametrization of S_0 , a representative of o . The sheared Reeb torus $u_{o,k}$ traces o on every component of every fiber of $pr_{S^1} \circ u_{o,k}$, these fibers being the circles $S^1 \times \{t_0\}$. We can say more:

Proposition 6.4. *Let J be (λ, α) -admissible. Each $u_{o,k}$ is J -holomorphic for a unique complex structure on T^2 , and every $u \in \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^1(J, A_\beta^1, \beta)$ is the class of $u_{o,k}$ for a unique pair (o, k) , $o \in \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$, $0 \leq k < m(o)$. Here o is the orbit string traced by u on any component of any regular fiber of $pr_{S^1} \circ u$; we say that u traces o . In particular the map (6.2), with J in place of J^λ , is injective, and it is a bijection onto its image*

$$\overline{\mathcal{M}}^{\text{Reeb}}(J, A_\beta^1, \beta) := \mathcal{P}(\mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)),$$

whose elements we call **Reeb tori**.² (There is an analogous statement for $\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^n(J, A_\beta^n, \beta)$, $n > 1$, where $A_\beta^n = n \cdot \beta \otimes [S^1]$.)

In the particular case of J^λ , the domains of the Reeb tori are “rectangular”, that is quotients of the complex plane by rectangular lattices, while the domains of the sheared Reeb tori (6.3), $k \neq 0$, are not. Rectangularity also fails for the generalized Reeb tori of Section 7.1, for the mapping torus of some strict contactomorphism. Moreover, for more general compatible complex structures we might have nodal degenerations.

Proof of Proposition 6.4. Since $\mathcal{T}_o$ is tangent to the J -invariant distribution $\mathcal{D}$, it is a J -holomorphic torus, so each covering map $u_{o,k} : T^2 \rightarrow \mathcal{T}_o$ is J -holomorphic for the unique pulled back complex structure; in particular $\mathcal{P}(o)$, the class of $u_o = u_{o,0}$, lies in $\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^1(J, A_\beta^1, \beta)$. We now classify the elements of the moduli space. Suppose we have a curve $u \in \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^1(J, A_\beta^1, \beta)$, represented by $u : \Sigma \rightarrow M$. By Lemma 6.1 u is a Reeb 2-curve. Then $\widetilde{\Sigma}$ has no spherical components: a non-constant one gives a J -holomorphic map $u' : \mathbb{CP}^1 \rightarrow M$, which by Lemma 6.1 is a Reeb 2-curve, impossible by the second property in Definition 1.11 as $H^1(\mathbb{CP}^1, \mathbb{R}) = 0$; and constant ones are excluded by stability, since they would form trees attached at single nodes to the genus one component of $\widetilde{\Sigma}$, which must then exist as u is non-constant, and the leaves of such a tree carry a single special point.

²It is in fact an equivalence of the corresponding topological action groupoids, but we do not need this explicitly.

We now show that u is a covering map onto $\mathcal{T}_o$ for some o . As $\tilde{\Sigma}$ has no spherical components, Σ is a smooth torus by the description of nodal elliptic curves in Section 4.1; that is, u is normal.

By the charge 1 condition $pr_{S^1} \circ u$ is surjective. By the Sard theorem we have a regular value $t_0 \in S^1$, so that $(pr_{S^1} \circ u)^{-1}(t_0)$ contains an embedded circle $S_0 \subset \Sigma$. Now $d(pr_{S^1} \circ u)$ is surjective onto $T_{t_0} S^1$ along $T\Sigma|_{S_0}$. And so by the first property of u being a Reeb 2-curve, $o = pr_C \circ u|_{S_0}$ has non-vanishing differential $d(o)$. Moreover, again by the first property, o is tangent to $\ker d\lambda$. It follows that o is an unparametrized λ -Reeb orbit.

Next, du vanishes at only finitely many points, and elsewhere $du(T\Sigma) = \mathcal{D}$. The distribution $\mathcal{D} = \text{span}(R^\lambda, \partial_\theta)$ is integrable, with leaves $\gamma \times S^1$ for γ a Reeb trajectory. A connected surface tangent to an integrable distribution lies in a single leaf, so $\text{image } u \subset \gamma \times S^1$ for the trajectory γ through a point of o , that is $\text{image } u = \mathcal{T}_o$.

Since $\mathcal{T}_o$ is tangent to the J -invariant distribution $\mathcal{D}$, it is a J -holomorphic torus, and $u : T^2 \rightarrow \mathcal{T}_o$ is a holomorphic covering map. Coverings $T^2 \rightarrow \mathcal{T}_o$ are classified by the finite index subgroups of $\pi_1(\mathcal{T}_o) = \mathbb{Z}^2$, with generators the simple orbit o_s underlying o and the S^1 factor. The covering has charge one iff its subgroup surjects onto the second factor; its index is then the multiplicity m of the orbit traced by S_0 , so $o = o_s^m$. The index m subgroups surjecting onto the second factor are $\Lambda_k = \langle (m, 0), (k, 1) \rangle$, $0 \leq k < m$, and Λ_k is the subgroup of the map $u_{o,k}$ of (6.3). Two coverings with the same subgroup are isomorphic as coverings, and the isomorphism is a biholomorphism for the pulled back complex structures. This proves the classification. Injectivity of $\mathcal{P}$ is automatic, and $\mathcal{P}(o) = u_{o,0}$, so $\mathcal{P}$ is a bijection onto the set of Reeb tori. $\square$

Lemma 6.5. $\overline{\mathcal{M}}^{\text{Reeb}}(J, A_\beta^1, \beta)$ is open and closed in $\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^1(J, A_\beta^1, \beta)$. The same holds for the subset of Reeb tori of a cobordism moduli space $\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^1(\{J_t\}, A_\beta^1, \beta)$, for $\{J_t\}$ a family of almost complex structures with each J_t admissible for the lcs-fication (λ_t, α) of a contact form λ_t on C , $\{\lambda_t\}$ a smooth family.

Proof. By Proposition 6.4 a curve u tracing o is a Reeb torus iff the subgroup $u_*\pi_1(T^2) \subset \pi_1(\mathcal{T}_o)$ contains the class of the S^1 factor. Suppose $u_i \rightarrow u$ in the Gromov topology, tracing o_i and o ; then $o_i \rightarrow o$ in $\mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$, as the fibers of $pr_{S^1} \circ u_i$ converge to those of $pr_{S^1} \circ u$. For i large the nearest point projection $\pi_i : \mathcal{T}_{o_i} \rightarrow \mathcal{T}_o$ is a covering map taking the class of the S^1 factor to the class of the S^1 factor. The maps $\pi_i \circ u_i$ are C^0 close to u after reparametrization, hence homotopic to u as maps into $\mathcal{T}_o$. So $u_*\pi_1(T^2) = (\pi_i \circ u_i)_*\pi_1(T^2)$, and this contains the S^1 class iff $u_{i*}\pi_1(T^2)$ does, as π_{i*} is injective and preserves the second coordinate. Thus the set of Reeb tori and its complement are both closed. The cobordism case is identical, with $\mathcal{T}_{o_i}$ the images of the curves at times $t_i \rightarrow t$. $\square$

We also have the map

$$(6.6) \quad \text{emb} : \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^1(J, A_\beta^1, \beta) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta), \quad u_{o,k} \mapsto o,$$

a left inverse of $\mathcal{P}$, whose fiber over o consists of the $m(o)$ curves (6.3). It is continuous, by the argument of Lemma 6.5, and proper, since the curves over a compact set of orbit strings have bounded energy; cf. Proposition 7.2. Thus for an open compact $N \subset \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$ both $\text{emb}^{-1}(N)$ and $\mathcal{P}(N) = \text{emb}^{-1}(N) \cap \overline{\mathcal{M}}^{\text{Reeb}}(J, A_\beta^1, \beta)$ are open compact subsets of $\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^1(J, A_\beta^1, \beta)$, the latter by Lemma 6.5.

Proposition 6.7. Let (C, ξ) be a general contact manifold. If λ is a non-degenerate contact 1-form for ξ then all the elements of $\overline{\mathcal{M}}^{\text{Reeb}}(J^\lambda, A_\beta, \beta)$ are regular curves. Moreover, if λ is degenerate then for a period c Reeb orbit o , the kernel of the associated real linear Cauchy–Riemann operator for the Reeb torus u_o is naturally identified with the 1-eigenspace of $\phi_{c,*}^\lambda$ - the time c linearized return map $\xi(o(0)) \rightarrow \xi(o(0))$ induced by the R^λ Reeb flow.

Proof. By Proposition 6.4 every $u \in \overline{\mathcal{M}}^{\text{Reeb}}(J^\lambda, A_\beta, \beta)$ is a Reeb torus. In particular, such curves have a representation by a J^λ -holomorphic map

$$u : (T^2, j) \rightarrow (Y = C \times S^1, J^\lambda).$$

Since each u is immersed we may naturally get a splitting $u^*T(Y) \simeq N \oplus T(T^2)$, using the g_J metric, where $N \rightarrow T^2$ denotes the pull-back, of the g_J -normal bundle to image u , and which is identified with the pullback of the distribution ξ_λ on Y , (which we also call the co-vanishing distribution).

The full associated real linear Cauchy–Riemann operator takes the form:

$$(6.8) \quad D_u^J : \Omega^0(N \oplus T(T^2)) \oplus T_j \mathcal{T} \rightarrow \Omega^{0,1}(T(T^2), N \oplus T(T^2)).$$

Here $\mathcal{T}$ is the Teichmüller space of the torus, of real dimension 2, so that $T_j \mathcal{T}$ accounts for the variations of the complex structure j . This is an index 2 Fredholm operator (after standard Sobolev completions), whose restriction to $\Omega^0(N \oplus T(T^2))$ preserves the splitting, that is the restricted operator splits as

$$D \oplus D' : \Omega^0(N) \oplus \Omega^0(T(T^2)) \rightarrow \Omega^{0,1}(T(T^2), N) \oplus \Omega^{0,1}(T(T^2), T(T^2)).$$

On the other hand the restricted Fredholm index 2 operator

$$\Omega^0(T(T^2)) \oplus T_j \mathcal{T} \rightarrow \Omega^{0,1}(T(T^2)),$$

is surjective by classical Teichmüller theory, see also [37, Lemma 3.3] for a precise argument in this setting. It follows that D_u^J will be surjective if the restricted Fredholm index 0 operator

$$D : \Omega^0(N) \rightarrow \Omega^{0,1}(N),$$

has no kernel.

The bundle N is symplectic with symplectic form on the fibers given by restriction of $u^*d\lambda$, and together with J^λ this gives a Hermitian structure (g_λ, j_λ) on N . We have a linear symplectic connection $\mathcal{A}$ on N , which over the slices $S^1 \times \{t\} \subset T^2$ is induced by the pullback by u of the linearized R^λ Reeb flow. Specifically the $\mathcal{A}$ -transport map from the fiber $N_{(s_0, t)}$ to the fiber $N_{(s_1, t)}$ over the path $[s_0, s_1] \times \{t\} \subset T^2$, is given by

$$(u_*|_{N_{(s_1, t)}})^{-1} \circ (\phi_{c(s_1-s_0)}^\lambda)_* \circ u_*|_{N_{(s_0, t)}},$$

where $\phi_{c(s_1-s_0)}^\lambda$ is the time $c \cdot (s_1 - s_0)$ map for the R^λ Reeb flow, where c is the period of the Reeb orbit o_u , and where $u_* : N \rightarrow TY$ denotes the natural map, (it is the universal map in the pull-back diagram.)

The connection $\mathcal{A}$ is defined to be trivial in the t direction, where trivial means that the parallel transport maps are the id maps over the loops $\{s\} \times S^1$. In particular the curvature $R_{\mathcal{A}}$, understood as a Lie algebra valued 2-form, of this connection vanishes. The connection $\mathcal{A}$ determines a real linear CR operator $D_{\mathcal{A}}$ on N in the standard way, take the complex anti-linear part of the vertical differential of a section. Explicitly,

$$D_{\mathcal{A}} : \Omega^0(N) \rightarrow \Omega^{0,1}(N),$$

is defined by

$$D_{\mathcal{A}}(\mu)(p) = j_\lambda \circ \pi^{\text{vert}}(\mu(p)) \circ d\mu(p) - \pi^{\text{vert}}(\mu(p)) \circ d\mu(p) \circ j,$$

where

$$\pi^{\text{vert}}(\mu(p)) : T_{\mu(p)}N \rightarrow T_{\mu(p)}^{\text{vert}}N \simeq N$$

is the $\mathcal{A}$ -projection, and where $T_{\mu(p)}^{\text{vert}}N$ is the kernel of the projection $T_{\mu(p)}N \rightarrow T_p\Sigma$. It is elementary to verify that the operator $D_{\mathcal{A}}$ is Fredholm of index 0 with the kernel isomorphic to the kernel of D .

Here is the reason. The operators D and $D_{\mathcal{A}}$ act between the same spaces. They have the same principal symbol, namely $\bar{\partial}$ for the Hermitian structure (g_λ, j_λ) on N . So their difference is C^∞ -linear in the section. That is, it is a zeroth order operator, given by a bundle map $N \rightarrow \Omega^{0,1} \otimes N$. A zeroth order operator is compact after the Sobolev completions. Hence D and $D_{\mathcal{A}}$ are Fredholm of the same index. That index is 0, since $\mathcal{A}$ is flat and so $c_1(N) = 0$. Finally, the bundle map in question is the

difference between the linearization of the R^λ flow in the normal direction and the $\mathcal{A}$ -parallel transport. These agree, by the definition of $\mathcal{A}$. So the bundle map vanishes, and $D = D_{\mathcal{A}}$. This is the standard computation of the linearized operator at a trivial cylinder over a Reeb orbit in a symplectization, of which u_o is the $\mathbb{Z}$ -quotient: $(C \times S^1, J^\lambda)$ is the quotient of $\mathbb{R} \times C$, with the cylindrical almost complex structure $J\partial_r = -R^\lambda$, $J = J^\lambda$ on ξ , by $r \mapsto r + 1$; there the linearized operator at the trivial cylinder is $\partial_s + J\nabla_t$ for ∇ the connection on ξ along o whose parallel transport is the linearized Reeb flow, see for instance Wendl [35]. See also [24, Section 10.1] for a computation of this kind in much greater generality.

We have a differential 2-form Ω on the total space of N defined as follows. On the fibers $T^{vert}N$, $\Omega = u_*\omega$, for $\omega = d_\alpha\lambda$, and for $T^{vert}N \subset TN$ denoting the vertical tangent space, or subspace of vectors v with $\pi_*v = 0$, for $\pi : N \rightarrow T^2$ the projection. While on the $\mathcal{A}$ -horizontal distribution Ω is defined to vanish. The 2-form Ω is closed, which we may check explicitly by using that $R_{\mathcal{A}}$ vanishes to obtain local symplectic trivializations of N in which $\mathcal{A}$ is trivial. Clearly $\int_0 \Omega = 0$ over the 0-section, since it is an $\mathcal{A}$ -flat section. But any section is homotopic to the 0-section and Ω is closed, so in particular if $\mu \in \ker D$ then $\int_\mu \Omega = 0$.

Since $\mu \in \ker D$, and so its vertical differential is complex linear, it follows that the vertical differential vanishes. To see this note that $\Omega(v, j_\lambda v) > 0$, for $0 \neq v \in T^{vert}N$ and so if the vertical differential did not vanish we would have $\int_\mu \Omega > 0$. So μ is $\mathcal{A}$ -flat, in particular the restriction of μ over all slices $S^1 \times \{t\}$ is identified with a period c orbit of the linearized at o R^λ Reeb flow, and which does not depend on t as $\mathcal{A}$ is trivial in the t variable. So the kernel of D is identified with the vector space of period c orbits of the linearized at o R^λ Reeb flow, as needed. $\square$

Proposition 6.9. *Let λ be a contact form on a $(2n+1)$ -fold C , and o a non-degenerate, period c , λ -Reeb orbit, then the orientation of $[u_o]$ induced by the determinant line bundle orientation of $\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^1(J^\lambda, A_\beta, \beta)$, is $(-1)^{CZ(o)-n}$, which is*

$$\text{sign Det}(\text{id}|_{\xi(o(0))} - \phi_{c,*}^\lambda|_{\xi(o(0))}).$$

Proof of Proposition 6.9. Abbreviate u_o by u . Let $N \rightarrow T^2$ be the vector bundle associated to u as in the proof of Proposition 6.7. Fix a trivialization ϕ of N induced by any trivialization of the contact distribution ξ along o in the obvious sense: N is the pullback of ξ along the composition

$$T^2 \rightarrow S^1 \xrightarrow{o} C.$$

Let the symplectic connection $\mathcal{A}$ on N be defined as before. Then the pullback connection $\mathcal{A}' := \phi^*\mathcal{A}$ on $T^2 \times \mathbb{R}^{2n}$ is a connection whose parallel transport paths $p : [0, 1] \rightarrow \text{Symp}(\mathbb{R}^{2n})$, along the closed loops $S^1 \times \{t\}$, start at id and are independent of t . And so the parallel transport path of $\mathcal{A}'$ along $\{s\} \times S^1$ is constant, that is $\mathcal{A}'$ is trivial in the t variable. We shall call such a connection $\mathcal{A}'$ on $T^2 \times \mathbb{R}^{2n}$ induced by p .

By non-degeneracy assumption on o , the map $p(1)$ has no 1-eigenvalues. Let $p'' : [0, 1] \rightarrow \text{Symp}(\mathbb{R}^{2n})$ be a path from $p(1)$ to a unitary map $p''(1)$, with $p''(1)$ having no 1-eigenvalues, and s.t. p'' has only simple crossings with the Maslov cycle. Let p' be the concatenation of p and p'' . The path p' is homotopic relative end points to a unitary geodesic path h starting at id and having regular crossings, so $CZ(p') = CZ(h)$. At each interior crossing of h the crossing form has even signature, by unitarity. At time 0 the crossing form of h is $\Gamma(h, 0) = \bigoplus_j \vartheta_j |z_j|^2$ on $\mathbb{C}^n$, for $h(t) = \bigoplus_j e^{i\vartheta_j t}$ with all $\vartheta_j \neq 0$, so $\frac{1}{2} \text{sign } \Gamma(h, 0)$ is the number of positive ϑ_j minus the number of negative ones, which is congruent to n modulo 2. Hence

$$CZ(p') \equiv CZ(h) \equiv n \pmod{2},$$

in the notation of [27]. Consequently,

$$(6.10) \quad CZ(p'') \equiv CZ(p) - n \pmod{2},$$

by additivity of the Conley–Zehnder index.

Let us then define a free homotopy $\{p_t\}$ of p to p' , p_t is the concatenation of p with $p''|_{[0,t]}$, reparametrized to have domain $[0, 1]$ at each moment t . This determines a homotopy $\{\mathcal{A}'_t\}$ of connections induced by $\{p_t\}$. By the proof of Proposition 6.7, the CR operator D_t determined by each $\mathcal{A}'_t$ is surjective except at some finite collection of times $t_i \in (0, 1)$, $i \in \{1, \dots, \nu\}$ determined by the crossing times of p'' with the Maslov cycle, and the dimension of the kernel of D_{t_i} is the dimension of the 1-eigenspace of $p''(t_i)$, which is 1 by the assumption that the crossings of p'' are simple.

The operator D_1 is not complex linear. To fix this we concatenate the homotopy $\{D_t\}$ with the homotopy $\{\tilde{D}_t\}$ defined as follows. Let $\{\tilde{\mathcal{A}}_t\}$ be a homotopy of $\mathcal{A}'_1$ to a unitary connection $\tilde{\mathcal{A}}_1$, where the homotopy $\{\tilde{\mathcal{A}}_t\}$ is through connections induced by paths $\{\tilde{p}_t\}$, giving a path homotopy of $p' = \tilde{p}_0$ to h . Then $\{\tilde{D}_t\}$ is defined to be induced by $\{\tilde{\mathcal{A}}_t\}$.

Let us denote by $\{D'_t\}$ the concatenation of $\{D_t\}$ with $\{\tilde{D}_t\}$. By construction, in the second half of the homotopy $\{D'_t\}$, D'_t is surjective. And D'_1 is induced by a unitary connection, since it is induced by unitary path $\tilde{p}_1$. Consequently, D'_1 is complex linear. By the above construction, for the homotopy $\{D'_t\}$, D'_t is surjective except for ν times in $(0, 1)$, where the kernel has dimension one. In particular the sign of $[u]$ by the definition via the determinant line bundle is exactly

$$(-1)^\nu = (-1)^{CZ(p)-n},$$

by (6.10), which is what was to be proved. $\square$

The sheared Reeb tori (6.3) are handled by the same argument.

Lemma 6.11. *Let λ be a contact form on a $(2n + 1)$ -fold C , and let $o = o_s^m$ be a λ -Reeb orbit of multiplicity m , with o_s simple of period c_s . Let $P := \phi_{c_s, *}^\lambda|_{\xi(o(0))}$ be the linearized return map of o_s . For the sheared Reeb torus $u_{o,k}$, $0 \leq k < m$, set $d := \gcd(k, m)$, with $\gcd(0, m) = m$. Then the kernel of the real linear Cauchy–Riemann operator $D : \Omega^0(N) \rightarrow \Omega^{0,1}(N)$ of $u_{o,k}$, defined as in the proof of Proposition 6.7, is naturally identified with $\ker(P^d - \text{id})$, the 1-eigenspace of the linearized return map of o_s^d . In particular, if o is non-degenerate then $u_{o,k}$ is regular, and its orientation sign is*

$$(-1)^{CZ(o_s^d)-n} = i(o_s^d),$$

in the notation of (A.2).

Proof. We have $u_{o,k} = u_{o_s} \circ c_k$, for $u_{o_s}(\sigma, t) = (o_s(\sigma), t)$ the Reeb torus of o_s and $c_k : T^2 \rightarrow T^2$, $c_k(s, t) = (ms + kt, t)$, a covering map of degree m , which is holomorphic for the complex structures on the two tori for which $u_{o,k}$ and u_{o_s} are J^λ -holomorphic, as u_{o_s} is an immersion. Hence $N = c_k^* N_s$ and $D = c_k^* D_s$, for N_s , D_s the normal bundle and normal Cauchy–Riemann operator of u_{o_s} . Let $\mathcal{A}_s$ be the connection on N_s of the proof of Proposition 6.7: parallel transport by the linearized R^λ flow along the projection to C of paths in T^2 . Its holonomy along the loop $S^1 \times \{t\}$ is P , and along $\{\sigma\} \times S^1$ it is the identity. Set $\mathcal{A} := c_k^* \mathcal{A}_s$. The loops $s \mapsto (s, t)$ and $t \mapsto (s, t)$ in the domain of $u_{o,k}$ are mapped by c_k to loops in the classes $(m, 0)$ and $(k, 1)$ of $\pi_1(T^2) = \mathbb{Z}^2$, so the holonomies of $\mathcal{A}$ along them are P^m and P^k . As $D_s = D_{\mathcal{A}_s}$ by the proof of Proposition 6.7, we get $D = c_k^* D_{\mathcal{A}_s} = D_{\mathcal{A}}$, and the argument there, with the pulled back 2-form Ω , shows that every $\mu \in \ker D$ is $\mathcal{A}$ -flat. So $\ker D$ is identified with the subspace of $\xi(o(0))$ fixed by both holonomies, which is $\ker(P^m - \text{id}) \cap \ker(P^k - \text{id}) = \ker(P^d - \text{id})$, since d divides m and k and is an integer combination of them.

For the sign we run the proof of Proposition 6.9 with p the path of the linearized R^λ flow along o_s over one period, so that $p(1) = P$, choosing the path p'' generic, so that all crossings of $p''(t)$ with the eigenvalues $e^{2\pi i j/d}$, $j \in \mathbb{Z}/d$, are regular. Along the resulting homotopy of connections, the operator induced on $c_k^* N_s$ has kernel identified, by the above, with the 1-eigenspace of $p_t(1)^d$, with the same crossing forms as the operator induced on the normal bundle of the Reeb torus $u_{o_s^d} = u_{o_s} \circ c_0$ of the

d -fold cover, $c_0(s, t) = (ds, t)$, by the pullbacks under c_0 of the same connections, whose kernel is again the 1-eigenspace of $p_t(1)^d$. Both homotopies end at complex linear operators. So the two spectral flows coincide, and the sign of $u_{o,k}$ is that of $u_{o_s^d}$, which is $(-1)^{CZ(o_s^d)-n}$ by Proposition 6.9. $\square$

For an open compact $N \subset \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$ and $e \geq 1$ let

$$N^{(e)} := \{o' \in \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \gamma) \mid \gamma^e = \beta, o'^e \in N\}$$

be the set of e -th roots of elements of N , where o'^e is the e -fold iterate of o' and γ^e the class of the e -fold iterate of a loop in class γ . Iteration $o' \mapsto o'^e$ is continuous and proper on the space of all orbit strings, so $N^{(e)}$ is open and compact and meets only finitely many classes γ ; we write $i(N^{(e)}, R^\lambda)$ for the sum of the Fuller indices of its intersections with these $\mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \gamma)$. Clearly $N^{(1)} = N$, and $N^{(e)} = \emptyset$ once e exceeds the multiplicity of every element of N ; the multiplicity is bounded on N , as the period is continuous, hence bounded on N , while the periods of simple orbits are bounded below. Set

$$(6.12) \quad \hat{i}(N, R^\lambda, \beta) := \sum_{e \geq 1} \frac{\varphi(e)}{e} i(N^{(e)}, R^\lambda),$$

for φ Euler's totient function. When N is finite and non-degenerate, writing $o = o_s^{m(o)}$ with o_s simple, and using that $o \mapsto o^{1/e} := o_s^{m(o)/e}$ is a bijection from $\{o \in N \mid e \mid m(o)\}$ onto $N^{(e)}$ with $m(o^{1/e}) = m(o)/e$, this reads

$$(6.13) \quad \hat{i}(N, R^\lambda, \beta) = \sum_{o \in N} \frac{1}{m(o)} \sum_{d \mid m(o)} \varphi\left(\frac{m(o)}{d}\right) i(o_s^d) = \sum_{o \in N} \frac{1}{m(o)} \sum_{g \in \mathbb{Z}/m(o)} i\left(o_s^{m(o)/\text{ord}(g)}\right),$$

the last sum being over the stabilizer $\mathbb{Z}/m(o) \subset S^1$ of o under reparametrization. So $\hat{i}$ counts pairs (o, g) , g in the stabilizer of o , each weighted by the fixed point index of the quotient orbit string $o/\langle g \rangle = o_s^{m(o)/\text{ord}(g)}$: it is a Lefschetz number on the inertia groupoid of the orbit space. It coincides with $i(N, R^\lambda, \beta)$ when all elements of N are simple.

Theorem 6.14. *Let $N \subset \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$ be open and compact, and let $\mathcal{P}$, emb be as in (6.2), (6.6), for $J = J^\lambda$. Then*

$$(6.15) \quad GW_1^1(\mathcal{P}(N), J^\lambda, A_\beta, \beta) = i(N, R^\lambda, \beta),$$

$$(6.16) \quad GW_1^1(\text{emb}^{-1}(N), J^\lambda, A_\beta, \beta) = \hat{i}(N, R^\lambda, \beta),$$

where i is the Fuller index of Appendix A, $\hat{i}$ is as in (6.12), and the left-hand sides are the counts (5.4).

Proof. Suppose first that N is finite and consists of non-degenerate orbits $\{o_i\}$, with multiplicities $m(o_i)$ as in Appendix A, and write $o_i = o_{i,s}^{m(o_i)}$ with $o_{i,s}$ simple. By Proposition 6.9 the Reeb tori u_{o_i} are regular with sign $(-1)^{CZ(o_i)-n}$, where $\dim C = 2n + 1$ and the sign is as in (A.2), and by Lemma 6.11 the sheared Reeb tori $u_{o_i,k}$ are regular with sign $i(o_{i,s}^{\text{gcd}(k, m(o_i))})$. Each of these curves has isotropy group of order $m(o_i)$, see Appendix B. Hence

$$GW_1^1(\mathcal{P}(N), J^\lambda, A_\beta, \beta) = \sum_i \frac{(-1)^{CZ(o_i)-n}}{m(o_i)} = i(N, R^\lambda, \beta),$$

and

$$GW_1^1(\text{emb}^{-1}(N), J^\lambda, A_\beta, \beta) = \sum_i \frac{1}{m(o_i)} \sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}/m(o_i)} i\left(o_{i,s}^{\text{gcd}(k, m(o_i))}\right) = \hat{i}(N, R^\lambda, \beta),$$

by (6.13), as there are $\varphi(m/d)$ elements $k \in \mathbb{Z}/m$ with $\text{gcd}(k, m) = d$. Thus, the theorem follows for N as above.

In general, perturbing slightly we obtain a smooth family $\{\lambda_t\}$ of contact forms, $\lambda_0 = \lambda$, with λ_1 non-degenerate, that is with non-degenerate orbits, which is possible as non-degenerate contact forms

are C^∞ -generic, see [12], and, by [30, Lemma 4.1], an open compact subset $\tilde{N}_\mathcal{O}$ of $S(\{R^{\lambda_t}\}, \beta)/S^1$, in the notation of Appendix A, consisting of the class β orbit strings of the R^{λ_t} near N , with $\tilde{N}_\mathcal{O} \cap (L_\beta C \times \{0\})/S^1 = N$. Set $N_1 := \tilde{N}_\mathcal{O} \cap (L_\beta C \times \{1\})/S^1$, a finite set of non-degenerate orbits. By the invariance of the Fuller index, $i(N_1, R^{\lambda_1}, \beta) = i(N, R^\lambda, \beta)$; likewise $i(N_1^{(e)}, R^{\lambda_1}) = i(N^{(e)}, R^\lambda)$ for every e , applying the invariance to the open compact set of e -th roots of elements of $\tilde{N}_\mathcal{O}$, whose slices at 0 and 1 are $N^{(e)}$ and $N_1^{(e)}$; so also $\hat{i}(N_1, R^{\lambda_1}, \beta) = \hat{i}(N, R^\lambda, \beta)$. On the other hand, the maps emb of (6.6) for the J^{λ_t} assemble to a continuous proper map $\widetilde{emb} : \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^1(\{J^{\lambda_t}\}, A_\beta, \beta) \rightarrow S(\{R^{\lambda_t}\}, \beta)/S^1$, $(u, t) \mapsto (emb(u), t)$, cf. the proof of Theorem 1.8. So $\tilde{N} := \widetilde{emb}^{-1}(\tilde{N}_\mathcal{O})$ is an open compact subset of $\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^1(\{J^{\lambda_t}\}, A_\beta, \beta)$, with slices $emb^{-1}(N)$ at $t = 0$ and $emb^{-1}(N_1)$ at $t = 1$. Intersecting $\tilde{N}$ with the open and closed subset of Reeb tori of Lemma 6.5, we get the same with $\mathcal{P}(N)$ and $\mathcal{P}(N_1)$ in place of $emb^{-1}(N)$ and $emb^{-1}(N_1)$. Then by Lemma 5.5 the left-hand sides of (6.15) and (6.16) do not change when (N, λ) is replaced by (N_1, λ_1) , and the theorem follows from the finite non-degenerate case. $\square$

What about higher genus invariants of $C \times S^1$? Following the proof of Proposition 6.4, it is not hard to see that all J^λ -holomorphic curves must be branched covers of Reeb tori. If one can show that these branched covers are regular when the underlying tori are regular, the calculation of invariants would be fairly automatic from this data. See [38], [36] where these kinds of regularity calculation are made.

7. PROOFS OF MAIN THEOREMS

To set notation and terminology we review the basic definition of a nodal curve.

Definition 7.1. *A nodal Riemann surface (without boundary) is a pair $\Sigma = (\tilde{\Sigma}, \mathcal{N})$ where $\tilde{\Sigma}$ is a Riemann surface, and $\mathcal{N}$ a set of pairs of points of $\tilde{\Sigma} : \mathcal{N} = \{(z_0^0, z_0^1), \dots, (z_n^0, z_n^1)\}$, with $z_i^j \neq z_k^l$ for $(i, j) \neq (k, l)$. By slight abuse, we may also denote by Σ the quotient space $\tilde{\Sigma}/\sim$, where the equivalence relation is generated by $z_i^0 \sim z_i^1$. Let $q_\Sigma : \tilde{\Sigma} \rightarrow (\tilde{\Sigma}/\sim)$ denote the quotient map. The elements $q_\Sigma(\{z_i^0, z_i^1\}) \in \tilde{\Sigma}/\sim$, are called **nodes**. Let M be a smooth manifold. By a map $u : \Sigma \rightarrow M$ of a nodal Riemann surface Σ , we mean a set map $u : (\tilde{\Sigma}/\sim) \rightarrow M$. u is called smooth or immersion or J -holomorphic (when M is almost complex) if the map $\tilde{u} = u \circ q_\Sigma$ is smooth or respectively immersion or respectively J -holomorphic. We call $\tilde{u}$ the **normalization** of u . u is called an embedding if u is a topological embedding and its normalization is an immersion. The cohomology groups of Σ are defined as $H^\bullet(\Sigma) := H^\bullet(\tilde{\Sigma}/\sim)$, likewise with homology. The genus of Σ is the topological genus of $\tilde{\Sigma}/\sim$.*

We shall say that $(\tilde{\Sigma}, \mathcal{N})$ is normal if $\mathcal{N} = \emptyset$. Similarly, $u : \Sigma \rightarrow M$, $\Sigma = (\tilde{\Sigma}, \mathcal{N})$ is called **normal** if $\mathcal{N} = \emptyset$. Note that if u is a Reeb 2-curve, its normalization $\tilde{u}$ may not be a Reeb 2-curve (the second condition may fail).

7.1. Mapping tori and Reeb 2-curves. Let (C, λ) be a contact manifold and ϕ a strict contactomorphism and let $M = (M_{\phi, 1}, \lambda_\phi, \alpha)$ denote the mapping torus of ϕ , as also appearing in Theorem 2.11. More specifically, $M = C \times \mathbb{R}/\sim$, where the equivalence $\sim$ is generated by $(x, \theta) \sim (\phi(x), \theta + 1)$, with λ_ϕ and $\alpha = d\theta$ as in Example 2.10 for $c = 1$; see also [3]. Then $(M, \lambda_\phi, \alpha)$ is an integral first kind lcs manifold.

In this case $\mathcal{V}_{\lambda_\phi} = \mathcal{D}$, and in mapping torus coordinates at a point (x, θ) , it is spanned by $X_\lambda = (0, -\frac{\partial}{\partial \theta})$, $X_\alpha = (R^{\lambda_\theta}, 0)$ for R^{λ_θ} the λ_θ -Reeb vector field, where $\lambda_\theta = \lambda_\phi|_{C_\theta}$, C_θ the fiber over θ of the projection $M \rightarrow S^1$. Analogously to the Example 4.5 there is an S^1 -invariant almost complex structure on M , which we call J^{λ_ϕ} .

We now show that all Reeb 2-curves in M must be of a certain type. Let $o : S^1 \rightarrow C$ be a closed λ -Reeb orbit and suppose that image $\phi^n \circ o = \text{image } o$, for some $n > 0$, so that

$$\forall t \in [0, 1] : \phi^n(o(t)) = o(t + \theta_0)$$

for some $\theta_0 \in [0, 1)$, which is determined modulo $1/m(o)$, for $m(o)$ the multiplicity of o : there are exactly $m(o)$ choices of θ_0 . Fix one. Let $\tilde{o} : S^1 \times [0, n] \rightarrow C \times \mathbb{R}$ be the map

$$\tilde{o}(t, \tau) = (o(t + \theta_0 \cdot \frac{\tau}{n}), \tau).$$

Then $\tilde{o}$ is well defined on the quotient $T^2 \simeq S^1 \times ([0, n]/0 \sim n)$, and we denote the induced map by u_{o, θ_0}^n , called a *charge n generalized Reeb torus of o* . The $m(o)$ choices of θ_0 give $m(o)$ distinct maps with the same image. When $\phi^n \circ o = o$ we may take $\theta_0 = 0$, and then we write $u_o^n := u_{o, 0}^n$; the other choices are the analogues of the sheared Reeb tori (6.3), to which they reduce for $\phi = \text{id}$, $n = 1$. If the class $[o] = \beta \in \pi_1(C)$ we denote by A_β^n the class of u_{o, θ_0}^n in $H_2(M, \mathbb{Z})$, which does not depend on θ_0 . The class A_β^n can be defined more generally whenever $\phi_*^n(\beta) = \beta$, it is the class of a torus map $T^2 \rightarrow M$ defined analogously to the map u_{o, θ_0}^n , but no longer having the Reeb 2-curve property. As before we abbreviate A_β^1 by A_β .

By construction, u_{o, θ_0}^n is a charge n Reeb 2-curve and its image is an embedded J^{λ_ϕ} -holomorphic torus $\mathcal{T}_o$. Moreover, u_{o, θ_0}^n is J^{λ_ϕ} -holomorphic with respect to a uniquely determined complex structure on T^2 , similarly to the case of Reeb tori of Section 4.2. However, unlike the case of Reeb tori, this complex structure is not “rectangular” unless $\theta_0 = 0$.

Proposition 7.2. *Let $M = (M_{\phi, 1}, \lambda_\phi, \alpha)$ be the mapping torus of a strict contactomorphism ϕ as above, and let J be a (λ_ϕ, α) -admissible almost complex structure on M . Then:*

- (1) *Every charge n Reeb 2-curve $u : \Sigma \rightarrow M$ has image $\mathcal{T}_o := \text{image } u_{o, \theta_0}^n$ for some orbit string o with image $\phi^n \circ o = \text{image } o$. The string o is determined by u : it is traced by u on any component of a regular fiber of $\text{pr}_{S^1} \circ u$, for $\text{pr}_{S^1} : M \rightarrow S^1$ the projection.*
- (2) *Every element of $\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^n(J, A_\beta^n, \beta)$ is represented by a J -holomorphic covering map $u : T^2 \rightarrow \mathcal{T}_o$ of charge n , for a unique o as in part 1. The elements tracing o , in the sense of part 1, are exactly the classes of the $m(o)$ generalized Reeb tori u_{o, θ_0}^n , one for each choice of θ_0 .*
- (3) *The Fredholm index of the real linear CR operator (6.8) at u_{o, θ_0}^n is 2, so that, subtracting the dimension of the translations, the expected dimension of $\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^n(J, A_\beta^n, \beta)$ is 0.*
- (4) *The map*

$$\text{emb} : \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^n(J, A_\beta^n, \beta) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta), \quad u \mapsto o,$$

with o as in part 1, is continuous and proper, and its fiber over o has exactly $m(o)$ elements; in particular it is injective over simple orbit strings.

Proof. The proof of part one is completely analogous to the proof of Proposition 6.4: here $\mathcal{D} = \text{span}(R^{\lambda_\phi}, \partial_\theta)$ is integrable, its leaves are the surfaces swept out by a Reeb trajectory under the flow of ∂_θ , and such a leaf is compact iff it is of the form $\mathcal{T}_o$. For the second part, by the first part u has image $\mathcal{T}_o$, which is an embedded J -holomorphic torus as it is tangent to $\mathcal{D}$, so u is a J -holomorphic covering map $\Sigma \rightarrow \mathcal{T}_o$. As in the proof of Proposition 6.4, the charge n coverings of $\mathcal{T}_o$ whose fibers trace o are classified by the index $m(o)$ subgroups of $\pi_1(\mathcal{T}_o) \simeq \mathbb{Z}^2$ surjecting onto π_1 of the base circle of $\mathcal{T}_o \rightarrow S^1$, of which there are $m(o)$, and the $m(o)$ maps u_{o, θ_0}^n realize them, their subgroups being pairwise distinct.

We prove Part 3. Note that $c_1(A_\beta^n) = 0$, as by construction the complex tangent bundle along u_{o, θ_0}^n admits a flat connection, induced by the natural $\mathcal{G}$ -connection on $M_{\phi, 1} \rightarrow S^1$, for $\mathcal{G}$ the group of strict contactomorphisms of (C, λ) , cf. Proof of Proposition 6.7. The needed fact then follows by the index/Riemann–Roch theorem.

The last part follows from the first two: the fibers of emb have $m(o)$ elements by the classification, emb is continuous, by the argument of Lemma 6.5, and it is proper since the curves over a compact set of orbit strings have bounded energy. $\square$

Remark 7.3. For multiply covered o there is no canonical choice of θ_0 unless $\phi^n \circ o = o$, and in families of mapping tori the Reeb tori $u_o = u_{o,0}^1$ of an lcs-fication do not stay separated from the sheared Reeb tori. For instance let $C = S^3$ with its standard contact form, $\phi_t = \text{diag}(e^{2\pi i t}, 1) \in U(2)$, $t \in [0, 1]$, so that $\phi_1 = \text{id}$, and let o be the doubly covered Hopf orbit over $[1:0] \in \mathbb{CP}^1$. In the family of moduli spaces $\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^1(\{J^{\lambda_{\phi_t}}\}, A_\beta, \beta)$, β the trivial class, parametrize the curves over a fixed Reeb string o' of ϕ_t by $\theta \in \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$ with $\phi_t \circ o' = \theta \cdot o'$, in the notation of the Introduction. Along the loop $([1:0], 0) \rightarrow ([1:0], 1) \rightarrow ([0:1], 1) \rightarrow ([0:1], 0) \rightarrow ([1:0], 0)$ of pairs (fixed string, t), θ changes by $1/2$: it moves from 0 to $1/2$ on the first leg, as ϕ_t is the Reeb flow on the fiber over $[1:0]$, and it stays at $1/2$ on the other legs, as ϕ_t fixes the fiber over $[0:1]$ pointwise and $\phi_0 = \phi_1 = \text{id}$. So the Reeb torus $u_{o,0}$ at $t = 0$ and the sheared Reeb torus $u_{o,1}$ at $t = 1$ lie in the same connected component of the family. This is why the proof of Theorem 1.8 counts all charge 1 curves over a set of orbit strings, via $\hat{i}$ of (6.12), rather than Reeb tori only.

Proof of Theorem 1.12. Let $u : \Sigma \rightarrow (M = M_{\tilde{\phi},1})$ be a Reeb 2-curve in the mapping torus as in the statement. By part one of Proposition 7.2, there must be a charge n generalized Reeb torus in M . By the definitions this means that $\tilde{\phi}^n$ fixes the image of some closed Reeb orbit, so that ϕ^n fixes the image of some closed g_{st} -geodesic, which is impossible by assumption. $\square$

Proposition 7.4. *Let (C, λ) be a contact manifold with λ satisfying one of the following conditions:*

- (1) *There is a non-degenerate λ -Reeb orbit.*
- (2) *$i(N, R^\lambda, \beta) \neq 0$ for some open compact $N \subset \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$, and some β .*

Then:

- (1) *Let (λ, α) be the lcs-fication of (C, λ) . There exists an $\epsilon > 0$ s.t. for any tamed exact lcs structure (λ', α', J) on $M = C \times S^1$, with $(d_{\alpha'}\lambda', J)$ ϵ -close to $(d_\alpha\lambda, J^\lambda)$ (as in Definition 5.8), there exists an elliptic, J -holomorphic α -charge 1 curve u in M .*
- (2) *In addition, if (M, λ', α') is first kind and has dimension 4 then u may be assumed to be normal and embedded.*

Proof. If we have a closed non-degenerate λ -Reeb orbit o then we also have an open compact subset $N = \{o\} \subset \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$. Thus suppose that the condition 2 holds.

Set

$$\tilde{N} := \mathcal{P}(N) \subset \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^1(J^\lambda, A_\beta, \beta),$$

which is an open compact set of Reeb tori, by Proposition 6.4 and Lemma 6.5. By Theorem 6.14, and by the assumption that $i(N, R^\lambda, \beta) \neq 0$,

$$GW_1^1(\tilde{N}, J^\lambda, A_\beta, \beta) \neq 0.$$

The first part of the conclusion then follows by Proposition 5.13.

We now verify the second part. Suppose that M has dimension 4. Let U be an ϵ -neighborhood of $(\lambda, \alpha, J^\lambda)$, for ϵ as given in the first part, and let $(\lambda', \alpha', J) \in U$. Suppose that $u \in \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^1(J, A_\beta, \beta)$. Let $\underline{u}$ be a simple J -holomorphic curve covered by u , (see for instance [22, Section 2.5]).

For convenience, we now recall the adjunction inequality.

Theorem 7.5 (McDuff–Micallef–White [23], [18]). *Let (M, J) be an almost complex 4-manifold and let $A \in H_2(M)$ be a homology class that is represented by a simple J -holomorphic curve $u : \Sigma \rightarrow M$. Let $\delta(u)$ denote the number of self-intersections of u , then*

$$2\delta(u) - \chi(\Sigma) \leq A \cdot A - c_1(A),$$

with equality if and only if u is an immersion with only transverse self-intersections.

First, u is normal: otherwise $\tilde{\Sigma}$ has a spherical component, which is impossible as in the proof of Proposition 6.4. Hence $\underline{u}$ is normal, with domain $\Sigma' \simeq T^2$, and $u = \underline{u} \circ \pi$ for a covering $\pi : T^2 \rightarrow \Sigma'$. The charge of u is a positive multiple of the charge of $\underline{u}$, so $\underline{u}$ has charge 1. Now apply the adjunction inequality to $\underline{u}$, of class $A' = A_\beta / \deg \pi$: $c_1(A') = 0$, $A' \cdot A' = 0$ and $\chi(\Sigma') = 0$, so $\delta(\underline{u}) = 0$ and the inequality is an equality. So $\underline{u}$ is an embedded, normal, charge 1 elliptic J -curve, which is our claim. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 3.3. Let

$$U \ni (\omega_0 := d_\alpha \lambda, J_0 := J^\lambda)$$

be a set of pairs (ω, J) satisfying the following:

- ω is a first kind lcs structure.
- For each $(\omega, J) \in U$, J is ω -compatible and admissible.
- Let ϵ be chosen as in the first part of Proposition 7.4. Then each $(\omega, J) \in U$ is ϵ -close to (ω_0, J_0) , (as in Definition 5.8).

To prove the theorem we need to construct a map $E : V \rightarrow \mathcal{J}(M)$, where V is some neighborhood of ω_0 in the space $(\mathcal{F}(M), d_\infty)$ (see Definition 3.1) and where

$$\forall \omega \in V : (\omega, E(\omega)) \in U.$$

As then Proposition 7.4 tells us that for each $\omega \in V$, there is a class A , $E(\omega)$ -holomorphic, elliptic curve u in M . Using Lemma 6.1 we would then conclude that there is an elliptic Reeb 2-curve u in (M, ω) . If M has dimension 4 then in addition u may be assumed to be normal and embedded. If ω is integral, by Proposition 7.4, u may be assumed to be charge 1. And so we will be done.

Define a metric ϱ_0 measuring the distance between subspaces W_1, W_2 , of same dimension, of an inner product space (T, g) as follows.

$$\varrho_0(W_1, W_2) := |P_{W_1} - P_{W_2}|,$$

for $|\cdot|$ the g -operator norm, and P_{W_i} g -projection operators onto W_i .

Let $\delta > 0$ be given. Suppose that $\omega = d_{\alpha'} \lambda'$ is a first kind lcs structure δ -close to ω_0 for the metric d_∞ . Then $\mathcal{V}_{\lambda'}, \xi_{\lambda'}$ are smooth distributions by the assumption that (λ', α') is an lcs structure of the first kind and $TM = \mathcal{V}_{\lambda'} \oplus \xi_{\lambda'}$. Moreover,

$$\varrho_\infty(\mathcal{V}_{\lambda'}, \mathcal{V}_\lambda) < \epsilon_\delta$$

and

$$\varrho_\infty(\xi_{\lambda'}, \xi_\lambda) < \epsilon_\delta$$

where $\epsilon_\delta \rightarrow 0$ as $\delta \rightarrow 0$, and where ϱ_∞ is the C^∞ analogue of the metric ϱ_0 , for the family of subspaces of the family of inner product spaces $(T_p M, g)$.

Then choosing δ to be suitably small, for each $p \in M$ we have an isomorphism

$$\Phi(p) : T_p M \rightarrow T_p M,$$

$\Phi(p) := P_1 \oplus P_2$, for $P_1 : \mathcal{V}_\lambda(p) \rightarrow \mathcal{V}_{\lambda'}(p)$, $P_2 : \xi_\lambda(p) \rightarrow \xi_{\lambda'}(p)$ the g -projection operators. Define $E(\omega)(p) := \Phi(p)_* J_0$. This preserves $\mathcal{V}_{\lambda'}$ and $\xi_{\lambda'}$, and is ω -tame for δ small. It is made ω -compatible by applying the retraction ret of Lemma 5.12 separately on $\mathcal{V}_{\lambda'}$ and on $\xi_{\lambda'}$, which are ω -orthogonal; this preserves admissibility, and moves $E(\omega)$ by an amount tending to 0 with δ . Then clearly, if δ was chosen to be sufficiently small, if we take V to be the δ -ball in $(\mathcal{F}(M), d_\infty)$ centered at ω_0 , then it has the needed property. $\square$

Definition 7.6. Let α be a scale integral closed 1-form on a closed smooth manifold M . Let $0 \neq c \in \mathbb{R}$ be such that $c\alpha$ is integral. A **classifying map** $p : M \rightarrow S^1$ of α is a smooth map s.t. $c\alpha = p^*d\theta$. A map p with these properties is of course not unique.

Lemma 7.7. Let $u : \Sigma \rightarrow M$ be an elliptic Reeb 2-curve in a closed, scale integral, first kind lcs manifold (M, λ, α) , then its normalization $\tilde{u} : \tilde{\Sigma} \rightarrow M$ is a Reeb 2-curve.

Proof. By Lemma 3.6 we have a surjective classifying map $p : M \rightarrow S^1$ of α . Note that the fibers M_t of p , for all $t \in S^1$, are contact with contact form $\lambda_t = \lambda|_{M_t}$, as $0 \neq \omega^n = -n\alpha \wedge \lambda \wedge (d\lambda)^{n-1}$, the term $(d\lambda)^n$ vanishing by the first kind condition, and α vanishes on M_t , since $c\alpha = p^*d\theta$.

Let $\tilde{u} : \tilde{\Sigma} \rightarrow M$ be the normalization of u . Suppose it is not a Reeb 2-curve, which in this case, by definitions, just means that $0 = [\tilde{u}^*\alpha] \in H^1(\tilde{\Sigma}, \mathbb{R})$. Since $0 \neq [u^*\alpha] \in H^1(\Sigma, \mathbb{R})$, some node z_0 of Σ lies on a closed loop $\sigma : S^1 \rightarrow \Sigma$ with $\langle [\sigma], [u^*\alpha] \rangle \neq 0$.

Let $q_\Sigma : \tilde{\Sigma} \rightarrow \Sigma$ be the quotient map as previously appearing. In this case, we may find a smooth embedding $\eta : D^2 \rightarrow \tilde{\Sigma}$, s.t. $q_\Sigma \circ \eta|_{\partial D^2}$ is a component of a regular fiber Σ_t of the classifying map $p' : \Sigma \rightarrow S^1$ of $u^*\alpha$. See Figure 1, $\eta(D^2)$ is a certain disk in $\tilde{\Sigma}$, whose interior contains an element of $q_\Sigma^{-1}(z_0)$. Such a disk exists: as Σ has genus one, $[u^*\alpha] \neq 0$ and $[\tilde{u}^*\alpha] = 0$ force all components of $\tilde{\Sigma}$ to be spheres, on which every simple closed curve bounds a disk on either side.

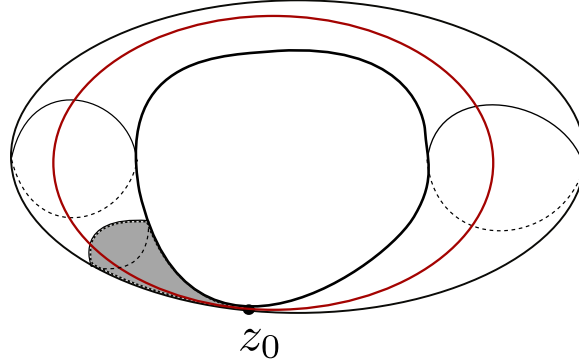


FIGURE 1. The figure for Σ . The gray shaded area is the image $q_\Sigma \circ \eta(D^2)$. The red shaded curve is the image of the closed loop σ as above.

Then analogously to the proof of Proposition 6.4 $\tilde{u} \circ \eta|_{\partial D^2}$ is a (unparametrized) λ_t -Reeb orbit in M_t . (The classifying maps can be arranged so that $u(\Sigma_t) \subset M_t$.) And in particular $\int_{\partial D^2} \tilde{u}^*\lambda \neq 0$. Now u (not $\tilde{u}$) is a Reeb 2-curve, and the first condition of this implies that $\int_{D^2} d(\tilde{u}^*\lambda) = 0$, since $\ker d\lambda$ on M is spanned by X_λ, X_α . So we have a contradiction to Stokes theorem. Thus, $\tilde{u}$ must be a Reeb 2-curve. □

Proof of Theorem 1.8. Let (C, λ) and ϕ be as in the hypothesis. Let $\{\phi_t\}$, $t \in [0, 1]$ be a smooth family of strict contactomorphisms $\phi_0 = \text{id}$, $\phi_1 = \phi$. This gives a smooth fibration $\tilde{M} \rightarrow [0, 1]$, with fiber over $t \in [0, 1]$: $M_{\phi_t, 1}$, which is moreover endowed with the first kind lcs structure $(\lambda_{\phi_t}, \alpha)$, where this is the “mapping torus structure” as just discussed. Let $tr : \tilde{M} \rightarrow (C \times S^1) \times [0, 1]$ be a smooth trivialization, restricting to the identity $C \times S^1 \rightarrow C \times S^1$ over 0. Pushing forward by the bundle map tr , the above mentioned family of lcs structures, we get a smooth family $\{(\lambda_t, \alpha)\}$, $t \in [0, 1]$, of first kind integral lcs structures on $C \times S^1$, with $(\lambda_0, \alpha) = (\lambda, \alpha)$ the standard lcs-fication of λ .

Fix a family $\{J^{\lambda_t}\}$ of almost complex structures on $C \times S^1$ with each J^{λ_t} admissible with respect to (λ_t, α) . Let $N \subset \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$ be an open compact set satisfying $i(N, R^\lambda, \beta) \neq 0$.

We first reduce to the case $\hat{i}(N, R^\lambda, \beta) \neq 0$, for $\hat{i}$ as in (6.12). As noted there, $N^{(e)} = \emptyset$ for e large, so there is a largest e_0 with $i(N^{(e_0)}, R^\lambda) \neq 0$, and $e_0 \geq 1$ as $N^{(1)} = N$. Set $N' := N^{(e_0)}$, an open compact set of orbit strings meeting finitely many classes γ , each with $\gamma^{e_0} = \beta$. Since $(N')^{(e)} = N^{(e_0 e)}$ has vanishing Fuller index for $e \geq 2$, (6.12) gives $\sum_\gamma \hat{i}(N' \cap \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \gamma), R^\lambda, \gamma) = i(N', R^\lambda) \neq 0$, so that $\hat{i}(N' \cap \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \gamma), R^\lambda, \gamma) \neq 0$ for some γ . If $o' \in N'$ is a fixed Reeb string of ϕ then so is its e_0 -fold iterate $o'^{e_0} \in N$, which is in class β . Replacing (N, β) by $(N' \cap \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \gamma), \gamma)$ we may therefore assume that $\hat{i}(N, R^\lambda, \beta) \neq 0$.

The map emb from part 4 of Proposition 7.2 induces a continuous proper map

$$\widetilde{emb} : \widetilde{\mathcal{M}} = \overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^1(\{J^{\lambda_t}\}, A_\beta, \beta) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta) \times [0, 1],$$

defined by $\widetilde{emb}(u, t) = (emb(u), t)$. Set

$$\widetilde{N} = \widetilde{emb}^{-1}(N \times [0, 1]).$$

As N is open and compact in $\mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$ and $\widetilde{emb}$ is continuous and proper, $\widetilde{N}$ is an open and compact subset of $\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}$. Set $N_i := \widetilde{N} \cap (\overline{\mathcal{M}}_1^1(J^{\lambda_i}, A_\beta, \beta) \times \{i\})$ for $i = 0, 1$, so that by construction $N_0 = emb^{-1}(N)$, for emb as in (6.6) for the lcs-fication (λ_0, α) . We use $emb^{-1}(N)$ rather than the set of Reeb tori $\mathcal{P}(N)$, since the latter is in general not the slice at $t = 0$ of an open and closed subset of $\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}$, see Remark 7.3.

It follows by Theorem 6.14 that

$$GW_1^1(N_0, J^{\lambda_0}, A_\beta, \beta) = \hat{i}(N, R^\lambda, \beta) \neq 0.$$

Then applying Lemma 5.5 we get that

$$GW_1^1(N_1, J^{\lambda_1}, A_\beta, \beta) \neq 0.$$

So $N_1 \neq \emptyset$, and an element of N_1 is a generalized Reeb torus u_{o, θ_0}^1 of $M_{\phi, 1}$ with $o = emb(u_{o, \theta_0}^1) \in N$, by construction of $\widetilde{N}$ and Proposition 7.2. In particular $image \phi(o) = image o$, and we are done. $\square$

We say that the action spectrum is **discrete** if the image of the period map $period : S(R^\lambda, \beta) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, $o \mapsto \int_{S^1} o^* \lambda$ is discrete.

Definition 7.8. We say that (C, λ) is **definite type** for class β if the action spectrum of λ is discrete and there is a renormalization $\{X^a\}_{a \in \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}}$ of R^λ , by smooth vector fields (not necessarily Reeb) in the sense of [30, Definition 2.4], s.t. R^λ is positive, respectively negative, infinite type in the sense of [30, Definition 2.6]: for some $E > 0$, every class β orbit of X^a with period in $[E, a]$ has positive, respectively negative, fixed point index, for every $a > E$, and $\sum_{o \in \mathcal{O}(X^a, a, \beta)} i(o)/m(o) \rightarrow +\infty$, respectively $-\infty$, as $a \rightarrow \infty$, where $\mathcal{O}(X^a, a, \beta) \subset \mathcal{O}(X^a, \beta)$ is the finite set of orbit strings of period at most a ; by the remark following [30, Definition 2.6] the last condition follows from the others when R^λ is not finite type. We then say that (C, λ) is positive, respectively negative, definite type. Here $i(o)$ is as in Appendix A; for a non-degenerate orbit of a Reeb vector field $i(o) = (-1)^{CZ(o)-n}$ by (A.2).

A typical example of definite type is the standard contact form λ_{st} on S^{2k+1} , as shown in [30, Lemma 2.13], and another example is the unit cotangent bundle of a non-positive sectional curvature Riemannian manifold.

Theorem 7.9. Let (C, λ) be a contact manifold of definite type for class β orbits, then every strict contactomorphism ϕ of (C, λ) , homotopic to the id via strict contactomorphisms, has a fixed Reeb string in class β . Furthermore, the same holds for every λ' sufficiently C^1 nearby to λ . In particular, for any contact form λ on S^{2k+1} , sufficiently C^1 nearby to λ_{st} , any strict contactomorphism ϕ of (S^{2k+1}, λ) homotopic to the id via strict contactomorphisms has a fixed Reeb string.

Proof of Theorem 7.9. For the full definition of renormalization we refer the reader to [30, Definition 2.4] (called there perturbation system). WLOG assume that (C, λ) is positive definite type. In particular, we may find a perturbation X^a of R^λ together with a homotopy X_t , $t \in [0, 1]$, s.t.:

- (1) $X_0 = X^a$, $X_1 = R^\lambda$.
- (2) $\mathcal{O}(X^a, a, \beta) = \{o \in \mathcal{O}(X^a, \beta) \mid \text{period}(o) \leq a\}$ is discrete, where period is the period map as above.
- (3) Each $o \in \mathcal{O}(X^a, a, \beta)$ is contained in a non-branching open compact subset $K_o \subset \mathcal{O}(\{X_t\}, \beta)$, where the latter means that:
 - (a) $K_o \cap \mathcal{O}(X_1, \beta)$ is connected.
 - (b) For $o, o' \in \mathcal{O}(X^a, a, \beta)$ $K_o = K_{o'}$ or $K_o \cap K_{o'} = \emptyset$.
 - (c) $\mathcal{O}(X_1, \beta) = \cup_o (K_o \cap \mathcal{O}(X_1, \beta))$.
 - (d) $(K_o \cap \mathcal{O}(X^a, \beta)) \subset \mathcal{O}(X^a, a, \beta)$.
- (4) $\sum_{o \in \mathcal{O}(X^a, a, \beta)} i(o)/m(o) \neq 0$, which holds for a large by the definition of definite type, cf. the remark following [30, Definition 2.6].

Set $N := \mathcal{O}(X^a, a, \beta)$, then by the condition 3 and by the non-branching property,

$$N = \sqcup_{i \in \{1, \dots, n\}} \mathcal{O}(X^a, \beta) \cap K_{o_i},$$

disjoint union for some $o_1, \dots, o_n \in \mathcal{O}(X^a, a, \beta)$. Set $\tilde{N} := \cup_{i \in \{1, \dots, n\}} K_{o_i}$. Then $\tilde{N} \cap \mathcal{O}(X^a, \beta) = N$. Set $N_1 := \tilde{N} \cap \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$, then this is an open compact subset of $\mathcal{O}(X_1, \beta)$.

Finally, using invariance of the Fuller index we get that $i(N_1, R^\lambda, \beta) \neq 0$. Then the result follows by Theorem 1.8. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 1.7. Suppose that λ is Morse–Bott and we have an open compact component $N \subset \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$, with $\chi^{orb}(N) \neq 0$, so that $i(N, R^\lambda, \beta) \neq 0$ by (A.4). If λ' is sufficiently C^1 nearby to λ then we may find open compact $N' \subset \mathcal{O}(R^{\lambda'}, \beta)$ s.t.

$$i(N', R^{\lambda'}, \beta) = i(N, R^\lambda, \beta) \neq 0.$$

See [30, Lemma 4.1] and the invariance of the Fuller index, Appendix A. Then the result follows by Theorem 1.8. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 3.4. Let $u : \Sigma \rightarrow M$ be an immersed Reeb 2-curve and $\tilde{u} : \tilde{\Sigma} \rightarrow M$ its normalization, an immersion with $d\tilde{u}(T\tilde{\Sigma}) = \mathcal{D}$. Set $\theta := \tilde{u}^*\lambda$. By the Reeb condition $\lambda(X_\alpha) > 0$, while $\lambda(X_\lambda) = \omega(X_\lambda, X_\lambda) = 0$, so λ does not vanish on $\mathcal{D}$, and θ is a nowhere vanishing 1-form on the closed surface $\tilde{\Sigma}$. In particular every component of $\tilde{\Sigma}$ has Euler characteristic 0. The foliation $\ker \theta$ of $\tilde{\Sigma}$ admits a closed transversal $\sigma : S^1 \rightarrow \tilde{\Sigma}$ with $\theta(\sigma') > 0$. Indeed, $\ker \theta$ is transversely oriented by θ , so it is tangent to a nowhere vanishing vector field V on the oriented surface $\tilde{\Sigma}$. Take a point q in the ω -limit set of some orbit of V , and a short arc τ through q transverse to V ; that orbit crosses τ at least twice, and an orbit segment from τ back to τ , closed up by a sub-arc of τ , can be smoothed to a closed transversal, see for instance [5, Chapter 4]. Along it θ does not vanish, so $\theta(\sigma') > 0$ after possibly reversing the orientation of σ . Then $o = \tilde{u} \circ \sigma$ satisfies $\lambda(o') > 0$ and $o' \in \mathcal{D}$, so it is a Reeb 1-curve.

For the second part, if an immersed elliptic Reeb 2-curve u is not normal, then $\tilde{\Sigma}$ has a genus 0 component, contradicting the above. $\square$

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A. FULLER INDEX

Let X be a complete vector field without zeros on a smooth manifold M . Set

$$(A.1) \quad S(X, \beta) = \{o \in L_\beta M \mid \exists p \in (0, \infty), \ o : \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z} \rightarrow M \text{ is a periodic orbit of } pX\},$$

where $L_\beta M$ denotes the free homotopy class β component of the free loop space

$$LM = \{o : S^1 \rightarrow M \mid o \text{ is smooth}\}.$$

And where recall that $S^1 = \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$. The above p is uniquely determined and we denote it by $p(o)$ called the period of o .

There is a natural S^1 reparametrization action on $S(X, \beta)$: $t \cdot o$ is the loop $t \cdot o(\tau) = o(t + \tau)$. The elements of $\mathcal{O}(X, \beta) := S(X, \beta)/S^1$ will be called *orbit strings*. Slightly abusing notation we just write o for the equivalence class of o .

The multiplicity $m(o)$ of an orbit string is the ratio $p(o)/l$ for $l > 0$ the period of a simple orbit covered by o .

We want a kind of fixed point index of an open compact subset $N \subset \mathcal{O}(X, \beta)$, which counts orbit strings o with certain weights. Assume for simplicity that $N \subset \mathcal{O}(X, \beta)$ is finite. (Otherwise, for a general open compact $N \subset \mathcal{O}(X, \beta)$, we need to perturb.) Then to such an (N, X, β) Fuller associates an index:

$$i(N, X, \beta) = \sum_{o \in N} \frac{1}{m(o)} i(o),$$

where $i(o)$ is the fixed point index of the time $p(o)$ return map of the flow of X with respect to a local surface of section in M transverse to the image of o .

Fuller then shows that $i(N, X, \beta)$ has the following invariance property. For a continuous homotopy $\{X_t\}$, $t \in [0, 1]$ set

$$S(\{X_t\}, \beta) = \{(o, t) \in L_\beta M \times [0, 1] \mid o \in S(X_t, \beta)\}.$$

And given a continuous homotopy $\{X_t\}$, $X_0 = X$, $t \in [0, 1]$, suppose that $\tilde{N}$ is an open compact subset of $S(\{X_t\}, \beta)/S^1$, such that

$$\tilde{N} \cap (L_\beta M \times \{0\})/S^1 = N.$$

Then if

$$N_1 = \tilde{N} \cap (L_\beta M \times \{1\})/S^1$$

we have

$$i(N, X, \beta) = i(N_1, X_1, \beta).$$

In the case where X is the R^λ -Reeb vector field on a contact manifold (C^{2n+1}, λ) , and if o is non-degenerate, we have:

$$(A.2) \quad i(o) = \text{sign Det}(\text{id}|_{\xi(x)} - F_{p(o),*}^\lambda|_{\xi(x)}) = (-1)^{CZ(o)-n},$$

where $x = o(0)$, $F_{p(o),*}^\lambda$ is the differential at x of the time $p(o)$ flow map of R^λ , and where $CZ(o)$ is the Conley–Zehnder index, see [27].

The Morse–Bott case. Recall [4] that a contact form λ on a closed manifold C^{2n+1} is *Morse–Bott* if its action spectrum is discrete, and if for every a in the action spectrum

$$P_a := \{x \in C \mid F_a^\lambda(x) = x\},$$

for F_a^λ the time a flow map of R^λ , is a closed submanifold of C with $T_x P_a = \ker(F_{a,*}^\lambda - \text{id})_x$ and with rank $d\lambda|_{P_a}$ locally constant. Suppose that λ is Morse–Bott and let $N \subset \mathcal{O}(R^\lambda, \beta)$ be a connected component. As the period map is continuous with discrete image, all $o \in N$ have the same period a , and $N = O_N/S^1$, where $O_N \subset P_a$ is the union of the images of the orbits in N , which is a connected component of P_a (the free homotopy class of the period a orbit through $x \in P_a$ is locally constant in x), and where $S^1 = \mathbb{R}/a\mathbb{Z}$ acts on O_N by the flow of R^λ . This action is locally free, the isotropy group of $x \in O_N$ being cyclic of order the multiplicity of the orbit string through x . Thus N is a closed orbifold, in general non-effective, of dimension $\dim O_N - 1$, and we write $m(p)$ for the order of the isotropy group of $p \in N$, which is the multiplicity of the corresponding orbit string. The *orbifold Euler characteristic* of N is

$$\chi^{\text{orb}}(N) := \sum_{\sigma} \frac{(-1)^{\dim \sigma}}{m(\sigma)},$$

the sum over the open cells σ of a cell decomposition of N along each of whose cells m is constant, equal to $m(\sigma)$, see Satake [29]. When m is constant on N , N is a closed manifold and $\chi^{\text{orb}}(N) = \chi(N)/m$. In general $\chi^{\text{orb}}(N)$ and $\chi(N)$ need not vanish simultaneously: for a 2-sphere with four cone points of order 2, $\chi^{\text{orb}} = 0$ while $\chi = 2$.

We now compute $i(N, R^\lambda, \beta)$, following Bourgeois [4, Section 2.2], cf. [30, Section 2.1.1]. Choose $\delta > 0$ so that a is the only point of the action spectrum in $[a - \delta, a + \delta]$, and let U be a small S^1 -invariant tubular neighborhood of O_N with $\bar{U} \cap P_a = O_N$, so that the closed R^λ -orbits with period in $[a - \delta, a + \delta]$ meeting $\bar{U}$ are exactly the orbits in O_N . Let $\bar{f} : N \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a Morse function on the orbifold N , meaning that its pullback to O_N is Morse–Bott with critical manifolds the S^1 -orbits over the critical points of $\bar{f}$ (such $\bar{f}$ exist, see [4, Section 2.2]). Extend the pullback of $\bar{f}$ to a smooth function f on C , supported in U and constant near O_N along the fibers of an S^1 -equivariant tubular projection $U \rightarrow O_N$, so that in particular $df(R^\lambda) = 0$ on O_N , and set

$$\lambda_\mu := (1 + \mu f)\lambda, \quad \mu \geq 0 \text{ small.}$$

For a critical point p of $\bar{f}$ let o_p be the R^λ -orbit string over p . Along the image of o_p we have $df = 0$, as f is constant along the fibers of the tubular projection and its restriction to O_N is critical there, so that $R^{\lambda_\mu} = (1 + \mu f)^{-1} R^\lambda$ along the image of o_p . Consequently o_p is, after reparametrization, a closed R^{λ_μ} -orbit of period $(1 + \mu \bar{f}(p))a$ with the same image, hence with the same multiplicity $m(o_p) = m(p)$ and in the same free homotopy class β . By [4, Section 2.2], for $\mu > 0$ sufficiently small these are all of the closed R^{λ_μ} -orbits contained in U with period in $(a - \delta, a + \delta)$, they are non-degenerate, and by [4, Lemma 2.4]

$$(A.3) \quad CZ(o_p) = CZ(N) - \frac{1}{2} \dim N + \text{ind}_{\bar{f}}(p),$$

where $CZ(N)$ is the generalized Conley–Zehnder index [27] of the degenerate orbits in N , which is constant on N . (As usual CZ depends on the choice of a trivialization of the contact distribution along the orbit, but its parity does not.)

By an Arzelà–Ascoli argument, after shrinking μ if necessary, no closed $R^{\lambda_{t\mu}}$ -orbit, $t \in [0, 1]$, with period in $[a - \delta, a + \delta]$ meets ∂U or has period $a \pm \delta$. Consequently the pairs (o, t) , $t \in [0, 1]$, with o a class β orbit string of $R^{\lambda_{t\mu}}$ with image in U and period in $(a - \delta, a + \delta)$, form an open compact subset $\tilde{N}$ of $S(\{R^{\lambda_{t\mu}}\}, \beta)/S^1$ with $\tilde{N} \cap (L_\beta C \times \{0\})/S^1 = N$ and, by the above, $\tilde{N} \cap (L_\beta C \times \{1\})/S^1 = \{o_p\}_{p \in \text{Crit } \bar{f}}$. So by the invariance of the Fuller index, (A.2) and (A.3):

$$(A.4) \quad i(N, R^\lambda, \beta) = \sum_{p \in \text{Crit } \bar{f}} \frac{(-1)^{CZ(o_p) - n}}{m(o_p)} = (-1)^{CZ(N) - \frac{1}{2} \dim N - n} \sum_{p \in \text{Crit } \bar{f}} \frac{(-1)^{\text{ind}_{\bar{f}}(p)}}{m(p)} = \pm \chi^{\text{orb}}(N).$$

The last equality is the Morse theoretic computation of the orbifold Euler characteristic, that is the Poincaré–Hopf theorem for orbifolds [29] applied to the gradient of $\tilde{f}$; when m is constant on N it is just the classical Morse count of $\chi(N)$, divided by m . In particular $i(N, R^\lambda, \beta) \neq 0$ if and only if $\chi^{orb}(N) \neq 0$.

B. REMARK ON MULTIPLICITY

This is a small note on how one deals with curves having non-trivial isotropy groups, in the virtual fundamental class technology. We primarily need this for the proof of Theorem 6.14.

Given a closed oriented orbifold $\mathfrak{X}$, with an orbibundle E over $\mathfrak{X}$ Fukaya–Ono [11] show how to construct using multi-sections its rational homology Euler class, which when $\mathfrak{X}$ represents the moduli space of some stable curves, is the virtual moduli cycle $[\mathfrak{X}]^{vir}$. When this is in degree 0, the corresponding Gromov–Witten invariant is $\int_{[\mathfrak{X}]^{vir}} 1$. However, they assume that their orbifolds are effective. This assumption is not really necessary for the purpose of construction of the Euler class but is convenient for other technical reasons. A different approach to the virtual fundamental class which emphasizes branched manifolds is used by McDuff–Wehrheim, see for example McDuff [17], [20] which does not have the effectivity assumption, a similar use of branched manifolds appears in [7]. In the case of a non-effective orbibundle $E \rightarrow \mathfrak{X}$ McDuff [19], constructs a homological Euler class $e(E)$ using multi-sections, which extends the construction [11]. McDuff shows that this class $e(E)$ is Poincaré dual to the completely formally natural cohomological Euler class of E , constructed by other authors. In other words there is a natural notion of a homological Euler class of a possibly non-effective orbibundle. We shall assume the following black box property of the virtual fundamental class technology.

Axiom B.1. *Suppose that the moduli space of stable maps is cleanly cut out, which means that it is represented by a (non-effective) orbifold $\mathfrak{X}$ with an orbifold obstruction bundle E , that is the bundle over $\mathfrak{X}$ of cokernel spaces of the linearized CR operators. Then the virtual fundamental class $[\mathfrak{X}]^{vir}$ coincides with $e(E)$.*

Given this axiom it does not matter to us which virtual moduli cycle technique we use. It is satisfied automatically by the construction of McDuff–Wehrheim, (at the moment in genus 0, but surely extending). It can be shown to be satisfied in the approach of John Pardon [26]. And it is satisfied by the construction of Fukaya–Oh–Ohta–Ono [9], the latter was communicated to me by Kaoru Ono. When $\mathfrak{X}$ is 0-dimensional this does follow immediately by the construction in [11], taking any effective Kuranishi neighborhood at the isolated points of $\mathfrak{X}$, (this actually suffices for our paper.)

As a special case most relevant to us here, suppose we have a moduli space of elliptic curves in M , which is regular with expected dimension 0. Then its underlying space is a collection of oriented points. However, as some curves are multiply covered, and so have isotropy groups, we must treat this as a non-effective 0 dimensional oriented orbifold. The contribution of each curve $[u]$ to the Gromov–Witten invariant $\int_{[\mathfrak{X}]^{vir}} 1$ is $\frac{\pm 1}{|\Gamma([u])|}$, where $|\Gamma([u])|$ is the order of the isotropy group $\Gamma([u])$ of $[u]$, in the McDuff–Wehrheim setup this is explained in [17, Section 5]. In the setup of Fukaya–Ono [11] we may readily calculate to get the same thing taking any effective Kuranishi neighborhood at the isolated points of $\mathfrak{X}$.

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